Summary of the Meaning of the Tantra Called Glorious Hevajra

Śrīhevajranāmatantrārthasaṃgraha · Toh 1193 · Derge Tengyur
དཔལ་དགྱེ་པའ་རྡོ་རྗེ་ཉེ་བ་བྱའ་རྒྱུ་ཀྱི་རྒྱ་བཤད་པ

The Summary of the Meaning of the Tantra Called Glorious Hevajra, known in Sanskrit as the Śrīhevajranāmatantrārthasaṃgraha and in Tibetan as Pal Gyepé Dorjé Zhejawé Gyü kyi Dön Düpa, is a concise commentary on the Hevajra Tantra, one of the principal scriptures of the yoginī class of Buddhist tantra. After paying homage to Vajrasattva and to great bliss, the text opens with an account of how the Buddha passed through the grounds to awakening, and then works through the chapters of both parts of the tantra in order, passing over whatever is easy to understand and dwelling on the lines whose meaning is hidden. Along the way it explains the three bodies of a buddha as abiding in the wheels of the yogin's body, why a disciple must be trained gradually, from the first lay precepts through the Buddhist philosophical schools to the practice of Hevajra itself, and how to decode the veiled verses in which the tantra conceals its mantras. It is Toh 1193 in the Tengyur, where it belongs to the section of tantra commentaries.

In the language of India: śrī hevajra nam tantra artha saṃgrah
In the language of Tibet: Summary of the Meaning of the Tantra Called Glorious Hevajra

Homage to Glorious Vajrasattva.

Having bowed to Great Bliss,
Perfect in the savor of great gnosis,
I shall write, as best I can,
The meaning of the Hevajra Tantra.

The Buddha, the Blessed One, generated the mind set on awakening and gathered the accumulations by way of the factors of awakening, the perfections, and so forth. Beginning from the generation stage, he brought relative truth to completion up to the seventh ground. From the eighth ground to the tenth he refined the three appearances to complete purity, and so attained the ten grounds. Through the stage of union, ultimate truth was spontaneously accomplished on the ground of Samantabhadra. He descended from the Tuṣita heaven to Jambudvīpa. Leaving his emanation body engaged in austerities in the world of humans, he went in his body of meditative

absorption, in which the mind had been transformed, to Akaniṣṭha, the highest heaven. Having gained manifest awakening, he attained manifest and perfect buddhahood by way of Secret Mantra, and he tamed the gods in the abode of Mahābrahmā, in the palace of Vaśavartin (lord of the highest heaven of the desire realm), on the summit of Mount Meru, and elsewhere. Then he went to the human realm and attained manifest buddhahood at the Vajrāsana. Although he taught many means of taming gods, humans, and others, in brief they are of three kinds.

To those who, because their view is poor and their conduct weak, are utterly impoverished in accumulated good qualities and the like, and who therefore seek awakening over a long time, he taught the Dharma of freedom from attachment through merely realizing the Four Noble Truths and the selflessness of persons.

Because some disciples are puffed up with the view of self, pride, attachment, and the like, to those who have great causes for compassion and wisdom he taught, by way of the eight collections of consciousness and so forth and the immeasurables and so forth, teachings endowed with the two kinds of selflessness, and he taught the grounds and perfections, profound and vast.

And to some disciples who are frightened by austerities and by giving up pleasing objects, who are especially devoted to the profound, who have become vessels for the suchness of phenomena, and whose mindstreams are moistened with great compassion, he appeared in emanated forms such as a wheel-turning monarch and taught, as it were, a way of practicing the dharma of desire; that is, he taught the conduct of Secret Mantra.

In this regard, there are beings who, through the power of habituation in other lives, delight in secluded forests; who cannot settle the mind in equipoise without such activities as ablutions, drawing maṇḍalas, austerities, offerings, fire offerings, and recitation; whose capacity to meditate on suchness is slight; and who delight in conduct with signs. To them he declared the Action Tantras (kriyā), which chiefly teach those general practices: the Vajroṣṇīṣa Tantra, the Vidyottama Tantra, the Tantra of Perfect Accomplishment, and others.

To those who are devoted to the special features of ritual action, who also apply themselves to the vast conduct of method and wisdom, and who delight in not abandoning the inward approach either, he declared the Dual Tantras (ubhaya), which accord with both aspects, action and yoga: the one called the Empowerment of Vajrapāṇi, the one called the Manifest and Perfect

Awakening of Mahāvairocana, and others.

To some disciples whose minds take boundless joy in suchness, who are especially devoted to yoga, and who, taking no delight in outer implements, wish to purify their mindstreams through meditative absorption, he declared the Yoga Tantras, in which the elements of action are few and the elements of yoga are chiefly taught: the one called the Glorious Paramādya, the noble Tattvasaṃgraha Yoga Tantra, the Tantra Compiling All Realizations, and others.

Some disciples have faculties that are sharp by their intrinsic nature. Through the power of past habituation, a single-minded aspiration to meditate on suchness is at work in them. No perception of any thing as distinct operates in them, their minds are thoroughly trained in the Great Vehicle, and they have deep faith in the conduct in which wisdom and method are non-dual. For such great-souled ones he made the yoga of suchness primary, and he declared the Great Yoga Tantras (mahāyoga), which proceed in the non-dual way, tantras of the great conduct with elaboration, without elaboration, and utterly without elaboration: the tantra called Sarvabuddhasamāyoga Ḍākinījāla Saṃvara, the Great Yoga Tantra called the Unfailing Accomplishment of Discipline, the Great Yoga Tantra called the Glorious Guhyasamāja, the Great Yoga Tantra called Supreme Definitive Expression, and others.

Of the countless Secret Mantra ways of liberation that he thus declared, the method tantras, such as the Glorious Guhyasamāja, and the wisdom tantras, such as the Candraguhyatilaka Tantra and the Vajra Net Tantra, are extremely hidden. Even the Teacher did not teach them to everyone at all times. He spoke them as the utmost secret, taught them as the domain of those possessed of very great wisdom, and declared them with their secret meaning concealed. Why is that? Even when the great sage Kāśyapa attained manifest and perfect buddhahood, he spoke but did not teach them. Likewise, even when Vipaśyin, Śikhin, and others attained manifest and perfect buddhahood, they did not declare the Secret Mantra ways of liberation. Even when the great sage Dīpaṃkara attained manifest and perfect buddhahood, he did not declare the secret tantras.

As the last five hundred years drew near, the Sugata Śākyamuni, in order to establish beings such as gods and humans who have the residue of past karma and good fortune in the great accomplishments with little hardship, within seven lifetimes and the like, displayed his body in the form realm as a

buddha himself, as King Brahmā, and in other forms, and exhorted them. In the desire realm, in order to tame Maheśvara (Śiva) and others, and the asuras, the māras, and others, he displayed the great body of Glorious Heruka, a body endowed with the nine moods of dance and so forth, and tamed them. Most of the gods, nāgas, and others of the desire realm he established in awakening through the Secret Mantra way of liberation, displaying the forms of Glorious Vajrapāṇi, Samantabhadra, Mañjughoṣa, Vajragarbha, and others. In Jambudvīpa and elsewhere, in order to tame humans, he appeared in the very body of a buddha and in the guise of a wheel-turning monarch. In order to tame the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), he appeared in the guise of the teachers of the non-Buddhists, in such forms as the five-faced one with five crest-locks, Pañcaśikha, and the naked ascetic clad in ashes, and tamed them. Likewise, appearing in whatever forms would tame each of the six classes of beings, he established them in awakening.

This tantra is more secret even than the secret, and it was taught as the very last of all the tantras.

As for the purpose of stating the title of this Glorious Hevajra Tantra first: the title is stated first so that it will not become a cause for those who listen to turn away. Moreover, at the outset the text is shown to possess the four elements of purpose and connection: the subject matter, the purpose, the connection, and the ultimate purpose. Of these, the subject matter is taught by the passage from "Thus did I hear at one time" up to:
Free of faults, you grant the peace of liberation;
You are the father, our very own self.

The purpose is this: in accordance with this tantra itself and the treatises, one enters the maṇḍala, receives empowerment, and has the pledges conferred; then, having obtained the oral instructions, one achieves accomplishment through the maṇḍala, the fire offering, offerings, recitation, and one-pointed meditative absorption. That is the purpose. To attain from this the accomplishment of the Great Seal (mahāmudrā), and to act for the benefit of beings in the manner of the twelve similes of illusion for as long as saṃsāra is not emptied, is the ultimate purpose. As for the connection: the four, beginning with entering the maṇḍala and having the pledges conferred, are the cause, and attaining the accomplishment of the Great Seal is the result. Because these two are connected as cause and result, that is the connection.

It is said that the first tantra of this taught thirty-two sections, and that from it the master extracted this one, of two sections, separately. Some say that the first section, the one called the Vajra Net Tantra, is the first tantra of this, and that of the two parts into which it is divided here, the first is the later tantra and the second is the later of the later; for this is not said out of partiality. The explanation of the meaning of the words has been condensed in brief from the commentary composed by the master Vajracenpra.

As for "Thus did I hear at one time," the meaning is that the compiler of this tantra, Vajrapāṇi, heard just this from the Teacher; it did not come down through intermediaries, but he heard this tantra directly on one occasion. Some say that the compiler of this is Vajragarbha. When the Blessed One was dwelling in the palace of Vaśavartin, on the summit of Mount Meru, and elsewhere, he spoke various other tantras; but at one time, when the Blessed One, Glorious Heruka, was dwelling in the bhaga of the queen, Vajragarbha too heard this tantra directly. Such is the meaning.

As for "the Blessed One, the Tathāgata": one who possesses the qualities of lordship and so forth is called the Blessed One, and he is one endowed with such qualities. The meaning is that, dwelling in the bhaga of the queen, he explained this tantra.

Alternatively, "thus" means that all the buddhas and bodhisattvas speak the Dharma as one, and not as different. Therefore this is called "heard thus by the Blessed One himself."

Moreover, "thus" is elvaṃ. The ekara is interpreted as the nature of wisdom, and the lvaṃkar as the nature of method. Explicitly, e is the Mother, lvaṃ is method, and the bindu is the awakening mind. It is realized that all the tantras and so forth arise from such an awakening mind; that is to say, "Thus did I realize at one time."

Or else, "in this manner by me" is e lvaṃm yā: e is joined with "this," lvaṃ is joined with "manner," "me" is joined with mā, and "by" is joined with yā. These are also connected with the four seals. Buddhalocanā is the action seal (karmamudrā) and is joined with e, which in turn is connected with "this." Māmakī is the Dharma seal (dharmamudrā) and is connected with lvaṃ and with "manner." Pāṇḍaravāsinī is the Great Seal and is connected with ma and with "me." Tārā is the pledge seal (samayamudrā) and is joined with yā and with "by." Thus it means "at one time, when it was known, or realized, as endowed with the four seals."

Or else, e lvaṃ is interpreted as teaching all the doors of the Dharma. As the Great Yoga Tantra called the Uncommon Secret also says:
e has become wisdom itself;
lvaṃ is the lord of supreme joy.
The indestructible bindu itself:
From it the letters too are born.
Whoever knows the reality
Of the letters of the Dharma seal
Will turn the wheel of Dharma
For all sentient beings.
And again:
In the illusion of the two letters e lve
The Omniscient One dwells here;
Therefore, at the start of teaching the sublime Dharma,
e lvaṃ is spoken first.
As this says, all phenomena arise from e lvaṃ, and therefore "thus" is stated.

If it is objected, "If compiling means presenting words in connection with their meaning, then when 'heard' is what is stated, why speak of knowing and realizing?", the reply is this. The Tathāgata spoke with an underlying intent, not without intent, and this is explained otherwise than by the literal sound of the words. That is, wisdom and method having become non-dual is "knowing"; and the culminating instant that comes from it, which is neither attachment nor freedom from attachment and is not apprehended even as the middle, is called "at one time."

As for "the Blessed One," this very tantra says:
Lordship and the others, perfectly complete,
Are explained as the six qualities;
The buddha glorious with their wealth
Is proclaimed the Blessed One.
Hence he is called "endowed." As for "destroyer," moreover: because he has destroyed the māras, beginning with the afflictions, it comes about that he is the Blessed One, and so he is called the Blessed One.

As for "the vajra of the body, speech, and mind of all the tathāgatas": the five tathāgatas dwell in the bhaga of the queens, Māmakī and the others. Some construe it as "The Blessed One, Hevajra himself, dwells in the bhaga of the queen."

As for "in this way": Vajragarbha made a request, saying, "What is the essence of the body, speech, and mind of all the tathāgatas?" And the Blessed One declared, "The essence of the body, speech, and mind of all the tathāgatas, more secret than the secret, is what you have asked about. Excellent, excellent!" These are words of praise. "Great vajra, Vajragarbha, great bodhisattva" is praise of the questioner, the bodhisattva Vajragarbha.

As for "Vajrasattva, great being, great pledge being, joyous essence": four Herukas arise from Hevajra. "Vajrasattva" is Vairocana, the nature of body; explicitly, he has one head and two arms. "Great being" is Amitābha; being the nature of speech, he has four arms. "Great pledge being" is the nature of mind; this is Vajrasattva, with three heads and six arms. "Joyous essence" is Hevajra himself, with eight heads and sixteen arms. The meaning is: "I shall explain such a meaning; listen!"

As for "Because it is indivisible, it is called vajra": this refers to what cannot be destroyed or torn apart, or to the indivisibility of body, speech, and mind, or to being endowed with the five kinds of gnosis.

As for "Sattva is the oneness of the three existences": sattva is Vajrasattva, and the three existences are the three realms. Thus one knows the three realms themselves to have the nature of body, speech, and mind, and "oneness" is knowing that their essence is without intrinsic nature.

As for "Through union with this wisdom": this is joining with the nature of reality through such wisdom. That itself is applied to Vajrasattva, and connected with the one described above, the nature of body, with one face and two arms.

As for "Perfect in the savor of great gnosis": because mirror-like gnosis and the others are spontaneously present, it says "perfect in savor." Alternatively, it means that the savor of the great bliss of Hevajra's gnosis is laid out in full and complete. This is applied to the four-armed one whose nature is Amitābha, and he is the one called "great being."

As for "Ever attending to the pledge": although "pledge" can refer to the pledges of eating and drinking, here it is taken as attending to wisdom, the embodiment of the pledge. Explicitly, it is applied to Vajrasattva with three heads and six arms, and it is of him that it says, "He is proclaimed the pledge being."

As for
"Great compassion is the joyous He,
And vajra is explained as wisdom,"
compassion refers to what pervades all. Joyous through compassion, it is method, and it is applied to the Father; he is said to be endowed with the joy of great bliss. That vajra is taught as wisdom is applied to the Mother, for "Mother" refers to wisdom. Explicitly, this is called the tantra of the non-duality of method and wisdom. The meaning is: "I shall explain the tantra in which method and wisdom are joined in this way."

If one asks, "Are not the Tattvasaṃgraha and the like wisdom tantras?": those teach a greater share of method and a lesser share of wisdom, whereas this is a tantra in which method and wisdom are joined as a pair. Because that method is especially great, it says:
"The tantra whose nature is wisdom and method
I shall explain; listen!"

As for
"The gaze, summoning, the great signs,
And the power of the wise work in many ways,"
"the gaze" refers to suppressing, expelling, fierce rites, and the like, which come below. "Summoning" is of obstructors and hinderers. "Signs" are those that come below. "Of the wise" refers to the activities, the eight accomplishments, and so forth.

As for
"The powers of gnosis and consciousness
Arise from the goddesses,"
explicitly, the meaning is that from the great bliss that is non-dual with the yoginī Nairātmyā one accomplishes perfect buddhahood, the accomplishment of the Great Seal, and attains the magical displays and powers of a buddha.

As for
"Therefore, first, the sole cause:
Heruka is the generator,"
one may ask, "If meditating on Heruka as a real thing does not bring liberation, how is one to proceed?" Well, the root text says:
"By meditating on this there is liberation;
From the bonds with which meditation binds..."
"By meditating on this there is liberation" means that one should take it as

unborn by intrinsic nature. "Bound by meditation" means being bound by meditating on it as a real thing, and "thing" refers to the body of Heruka. To know that very body as free of arising and ceasing, like the moon in water, is the meaning of "Through that, one should fully understand liberation." Therefore the wise one is one who knows the unborn, that is, who knows all things to be unborn by intrinsic nature.

So that, just as things are known to be without intrinsic nature, Heruka too may be known to be without real existence, it says:

"Gnosis abides in the body
And abides pervading all things."

Gnosis such as that described above is not found elsewhere; one should know one's own mind itself as luminous. Because gnosis is not something permanent, it is said to pervade all things; the meaning is that it is the nature of all. If one objects, "Then, since it is stated that it abides in the body, it is all things," it is not so: it is stated to be beyond the body. Therefore that gnosis is free of the nature of one and many; the meaning is that it transcends conceptualization, that is, the conceptualization that grasps at signs.

Some relate this to the own nature of wisdom. In general, the kinds of channel in which gnosis abides in the body are many, such as the seventy-two thousand nāḍīs, but in brief there are thirty-two, and the chief of these are three channels. Lalanā, of the nature of purified wisdom, abides on the right. Rasanā, of the nature of purified method, abides on the left.

Avadhūtī, the essence of the purified awakening mind, abides in the center, free from the conceptualization of apprehended and apprehender.

As for "Lalanā carries Akṣobhya": as urine comes from the right channel, it has the nature of Akṣobhya. "Rasanā likewise carries blood": this abides on the left and has the nature of Ratnasambhava. As for

"The one renowned as Avadhūtī
Is held to carry wisdom and the moon,"

this abides in the center; the meaning is that it has the nature of Amoghasiddhi.

"Abhedyā and Sūkṣmarūpā" and the rest are the names of the thirty-two nāḍīs. In order: Abhedyā produces the teeth and nails. Sūkṣmarūpā produces the hair of the head and the body hair. The channel called Divyā produces the skin. Vāmā produces the flesh. Vāminī produces the sinews. Kūrmajā produces the bones. Bhāvakī produces the kidneys. Sekā produces the heart. Doṣā

produces the eyes. Viṣṭā produces the bile. Mātṛkā produces the lungs. Śarvarī produces the intestines. Śītadā produces cold. Udrinidarni produces the stomach. Lalanā produces Akṣobhya. Avadhūtī produces the flow of wisdom and the moon. The one that carries blood is Rasanā. Pravaṇā produces excrement. Kṛṣṇavarṇā produces the interstices of flesh and skin. Sāmānyā produces saliva. Hetudāyikā produces earwax. Viyogā produces blood. Premaṇī produces fat. Siddhā produces saliva. Pāvakī produces the discharge of the eyes. Sumanā produces nasal mucus. Traivṛttā produces form. Kāminī produces sound. Gehā produces smell. Caṇḍi produces taste. Kataya produces tangible objects. Through Māradārikā, all phenomena are without intrinsic nature. These are the things the thirty-two channels produce and set in motion.

In their purity, these are the goddesses: Nairātmyā, Vajrā, Gaurī, Vārī, Vajraḍākinī, Pukkasī, Śavarī, Caṇḍālī, Ḍombī, Gaurī, Caurī, Vetālī, Ghasmarī, Bhūcarī, and Khecarī. Each of these goddesses has power over two channels and is their purity. Among them, Lalanā, Rasanā, and Avadhūtī are the yoginī Nairātmyā. The remaining twenty-nine should be relinquished with effort. Why? Because no one realizes them, and they cannot do the work of the basic purpose.

He asked, "Blessed One, what are they like?" He declared:
"They wholly transform the three existences without exception,
And are free of apprehended and apprehender."
The three existences are the three realms, and these themselves are transformed into the body, speech, and mind of Heruka. The apprehended is objects such as form. The apprehender is mind. Moreover, if the object is not established by its essential nature, mind too is not established; object and mind both having become emptiness is the abandonment of all conceptual thought. Explicitly, the appearing objects, the thirty-two channels and so forth, and the awakening mind that realizes them have become non-dual.

If one wonders whether there is some other means of accomplishing them as deities, it says:
"Otherwise, all the means
Are explained as the characteristics of things."
Apart from the means of purifying apprehended and apprehender, the characteristics of all things are imagined as Glorious Heruka; the meaning is to know this as without essential nature, like a reflection in a mirror.

As for "I shall explain by the divisions of the vow (saṃvara)": these are the words of the vow. The passage from āli kāli, the vowels and consonants, up to "yā is explained as Tārā" teaches the vow in general, and its divisions should be understood as the tantra states them in general, beginning with "the emanation wheel."

Here, "the emanation wheel of sixty petals" is the channel wheel at the navel with sixty-four petals; on the petals the thirty-two great ka are counted twice over. In the center write a. At the heart, on the eight-petaled Dharma wheel, place the four father-and-mother couples, and in the center set hūṃ. At the throat, on the sixteen-petaled wheel of enjoyment, arrange the sixteen great a, and in the center set oṃ. At the crown, on the thirty-two-spoked wheel of great bliss, arrange the thirty-two great ka, and in the center set ha.

As for the four moments, "Variety" and the rest: "Variety" is joined with joy; the meaning is delight in the father and mother appearing in various colors and shapes. "Maturation" is joined with intense joy. "Consummation" is joined with supreme joy. "Distinctive Characteristic" (vilakṣaṇa) is joined with the culminating joy.

As for the Four Noble Truths, the truth of suffering is joined with the emanation wheel, and the rest too should be joined as appropriate.

As for what is stated as "the reality of the self": when body and mind are broken down into their parts, they are not established by essential nature. As for the deity, the nature of the deity should be known to be like the moon in water. Knowing the three syllables as not established by intrinsic nature is the reality of mantra. As for gnosis, one should know self-aware cognition as not established. The joys, the Sthavira school, and the rest are not written here, since they are connected with what comes later.

As for "All of these are gathered in e lvaṃ": one should understand that, as above and below, the four, lvaṃ ma yā, are applied to method and wisdom.

As for
"Caṇḍālī, blazing at the navel,
Burns the five sugatas;
Having burned the five, Locanā and the rest, as well,
When haṃ is burned, the stream of the moon flows down,"
"at the navel" is to be construed with "the great passion, the blazing fire." A caṇḍālī is a woman of low caste. Just as no one is able to touch her, so kar, the suka that arises from ka, arises from the culminating joy, the luminosity; the

meaning is that no one realizes it and it is hard to touch. By it there is blazing: that is to say, the very fire of the desire of sentient beings blazes as emptiness. As for "burns the five sugatas": by it all the buddhas, those of the five families and the rest, are burned as well; this is an expression for melting into gnosis. Likewise, the meaning is that the five mothers too melt.

As for "When haṃ is burned, the stream of the moon flows down": at the aperture of Brahmā, the abode of great bliss, is the syllable called haṃ, whose nature is Amoghasiddhi. From it the seed of great bliss, the moon itself, melts and comes forth into the thirty-two nāḍīs. The meaning is that what is the nature of all the buddhas and bodhisattvas flows down into the kar of the kaloka, into kar, the luminosity.

Alternatively, "When haṃ is burned" means this: the buddhas of the ten directions are gathered at the crown, the abode of great bliss; great bliss itself and the buddhas mingle and become one, and that becomes the nature of haṃ. That itself becomes the nectar of the melted moon and enters the nāḍīs; and as for where, it flows down here, in the center, as luminosity. That is what is meant.

In another way, as for "Caṇḍālī's navel blazes": the navel is the hearth, the kaloka. The blazing is the luminosity of self-aware gnosis; explicitly, fire arises through the gnosis of union and blazes. As for "The five sugatas are to be burned": this is freedom from the five conceptions, desire and the rest. As for "Having burned the five, Locanā and the rest, as well": this expresses freedom from the conceptions of the five elements. As for "When haṃ is burned, the stream of the moon flows down": the haṃ at the crown, the moon, melts and comes forth along the pathway of the nāḍīs; as light blazes, it descends into space, and so one is free of all conceptual thought. The meaning is that the Great Seal of the five families is accomplished.

This verse is a great point of oral instruction. Because it is not the domain of logicians and of those who have entered the Lesser Vehicle, its intended meanings are explained in hidden form; they should be learned from the mouth of the guru. As it says even within this very tantra:
The ultimate is not realized through another;
It will not be found anywhere.
It is through serving and honoring the guru, the means and the cause,
And through being oneself endowed with merit.
Accordingly, the oral instructions are taught as they are passed from ear to

ear; they are not written down in words and letters. Therefore the point is this: if one serves and honors holy gurus for a long time, obtains the oral instructions, and then practices, one will succeed.

This is the explanation of the first chapter.

Next I shall explain the second, the chapter on mantras. Its purpose is to explain the mantras for torma, generation, recitation, accomplishment, and so forth.

akāro mukhaṃ is the first door of mantra; it means "All phenomena are emptiness." ādyanut is an expression meaning "born from that door." panna dvāt o āḥ hū pham svāhā. bruṃ āṃ jṛṃ khaṃ hūṃ are the seeds of the five families, with which one consecrates at the crown of the head, the forehead, the throat, the heart, and the navel.

As for oṃ de lvaṃ picu vajra hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā: oṃ goes at the beginning of all mantras. deva means the deities. picu: one generates all-pervading great compassion, and through that compassion the bodies, light, and so forth of the deities are gathered and absorbed into all sentient beings. vajra means that these too are indestructible by anything, like a vajra; or else it means gathering and absorbing the foregoing into oneself. The three hūṃ express that the body, speech, and mind of sentient beings and of the yogin are consecrated by the body, speech, and mind of the deity. The rest should be understood in the same way. As for the three crescent moons and bindus: the crescent is the vessel and the bindu is the nectar of gnosis, and the meaning is that this is absorbed into the mindstreams of oneself and of beings. phaṭ means abiding, and svāhā means making stable. The interspersing of oṃ a svā hvā phaṭ with the mantras is taught in the oral instructions.

a ka ca ta pa ya śa: he dwells at the center of a variegated lotus. This is because he has eight faces, or feet, and because of the eight liberations; and it means that he is surrounded by a retinue of eight goddesses. The sixteen letters, a ā and the rest, counted twice over, mean that Glorious Heruka is adorned with the thirty-two major marks. Or else, the mantras taken two by two are the heart mantras of the eight goddesses, and the meaning is the generation of the eight goddesses, Gaurī and the rest. Here someone asks, "If these mantras are the heart mantras of the eight goddesses, does it not follow, as a fault, that the Tathāgata lacks the thirty marks?" It is not so. Through the power of great compassion, the excellent marks themselves are

shown in the form of goddesses, so there is no contradiction.

As for oṃ trailokya: the meaning of oṃ has already been explained. trailokya means "the three worlds." akṣepa means drawing together, or gathering. Explicitly, the meaning is that the bodies, light, and so forth of all the noble ones of the three worlds are gathered into oneself and sentient beings. hūṃ and the rest are as before.

As for oṃ jvala jrala: jvala is blazing; explicitly, it means light blazing on the four arms. bhyo is taken, according to grammar, to mean "by those." Explicitly, it means that by the blazing ones the habitual tendencies of oneself and others are purified, or burned. As for "This is the mantra of the four-armed one": the meaning is that, of the sixteen arms of Hevajra, the four arms, the first two on each side, are generated by that mantra above.

As for oṃ kiṭi: kiṭi kiṭi is bringing māras or the vicious under control. Explicitly, the meaning is this: with his four or eight feet Hevajra tramples the eight gods; in his right hands he holds eight skull cups containing their wealth, the elephant and the rest, and in his left hands he holds the skull cups of the gods of the four elements, the sun and moon, Yama, and the Guardian of Wealth (Kubera); and by threatening them he brings their retinues, the yakṣas, māras, and the rest, under control. Or else, the meaning is that by reciting this mantra one generates the six lower arms on the right and left of Hevajra. hūṃ and the rest are as before.

oṃ āḥ hūṃ is the near-heart mantra. delva picu and so forth is the heart mantra, the root heart mantra. The powers and activities of the remaining mantras are clear from the root text itself.

kurukulle is a goddess of great power in performing fierce rites; by reciting it, the rites are accomplished. "Elephant's dust" refers to the dust that comes from its forehead when it has been given a great deal of liquor to drink and shakes its body.

"Zhiga khadakpachen" is an earthen bowl; the meaning is that the substances for the practice are placed inside it. "Having applied a tilaka" refers to the practice substance: bell metal is stirred, that is, ground with urine, and one should make a tilaka mark on the forehead. "Place it beneath the foot and recite," it says. "In vajra water" means that images of the sun and moon are made from rice and placed in a fine vessel, in water that has come from the vajra, and the mantra is recited. The "decoction of alakta" is in fact a decoction of the lac tree; the meaning is that with it one smears the inner pad of the

master's thumb. "The hand of the Guardian of Wealth (Kubera)" is the hand that grants fearlessness. The seven goddesses, Vajrā, Gaurī, Khecarī, Bhūcarī and the rest, mean that one is to accomplish, in particular, such ritual actions as harming, expelling, killing, and fierce rites. This is the explanation of the second chapter.

Now I shall explain the meaning of the third chapter. Regarding "First one should meditate on loving-kindness," the meaning is that the practitioner meditates on the four immeasurables. Regarding "Furthermore, the essence of awakening, and," knowing that all phenomena are by their essential nature unborn is the essence of awakening. Alternatively, one visualizes a lotus of eight petals in the space of the consort, and visualizes Heruka at its center and the eight goddesses, Gaurī and the rest, on the eight petals. Then light radiates from Heruka's seed syllable and fills the sky. As it gathers back, it is drawn into its original place at the center, and Heruka melts into light and becomes emptiness. Then, through the urging of the four goddesses of the directions, the syllable hūṃ arises; this is what is called "second, the gathering of the seed." Then the syllable transforms and becomes the body of Heruka; this is called "third, the image well perfected." "Fourth, the syllable is to be firmly set in place" means that one should meditate on hūṃ upon a sun at the heart of Heruka. "In front, visualize a sun from raṃ" teaches what one first focuses on when one first enters into meditation.

Here a questioner says: "Since it is stated that the practitioner, staying in a charnel ground or a similar place, first visualizes himself in the body of Heruka, meditates on raṃ upon a sun at his heart, and after that meditates on the immeasurables, why do the immeasurables come first here?" We reply: That is true, but it has been taught in a scrambled order in order to keep it secret from non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) and others, and because the deluded would rashly take it up without relying on a master. "In front, visualize a sun from raṃ" means that one visualizes, in front of the yogin, a sun maṇḍala arising from raṃ. "Then the sun, hūṃ, the crossed vajra" means that one visualizes a crossed vajra upon the sun and focuses on hūṃ at the center of that vajra. Many vajra mātṛkās emanate from the vajra and fill the sky, and from them one should seal the boundaries with the vajra fence, the net, the ritual pegs, and so on. Regarding "First, having visualized a corpse," one visualizes the god Maheśvara as one's seat. Since he has emptiness as his intrinsic nature, one meditates on him as the nature of reality. The yogin, seated upon him, "should visualize the form of glorious Heruka": this passage and what follows are easy

to understand. The fourth chapter, on the empowerment of the deities, is also easy to understand.

Next I shall explain the fifth chapter. "Mother and sister" teaches the visualization of the consorts, Locanā and the rest, and it is connected with what comes below. "She is to be served with diligence, and no distinction whatever is to be made" means that one should worship those consorts properly and not entertain thoughts of good and bad and the like. "If secrecy is not kept, snakes and fire, thieves and spirits bring suffering" means that if one explains or shows the secret of worshipping the consort in such a practice to someone who is not a fit vessel, then in this very life one will be seized by snakes, burned by fire, robbed of one's wealth by others, seized by grahas, and tormented by many sufferings such as illness.

"The mudrās of the five families are explained as the cause of liberation," and "with the vajra mudrā and the rest": this refers to the consorts, such as Māmakī, consort of the vajra family. Since they are of a nature that gives rise to wisdom, they are called "the cause of liberation." As for the vajra mudrā, one visualizes her as belonging to whatever one's own family is, and when one worships nondually with her, one's own vajra organ is itself the vajra mudrā, and "with" is said of the consort's mudrā. "And the rest" is meant to include the jewel family and the others. In actuality, these mean the mudrās that are the organs of the male and female partners. The rest is easy to understand.

"Fully explained as six families" refers to the five beginning with Vajrasattva, together with Akṣobhya, making six. "Brahmā, passed beyond sorrow, is the Buddha": this matches the six with the families. Brahmā is the Tathāgata family. Viṣṇu is the vajra family. "Śiva, the pure" is Mahādeva, that is, the karma family. "The All abides in the self of all" is the jewel family. "The sublime blissful mind" is the lotus family. "Fully awakened" is the family of Akṣobhya. "Whatever body is truly endowed" means that the yogin's body is endowed with the deities mentioned above. Since that very body has become the deity and has the deity as its nature, it is called "deity." The rest is easy to understand.

Regarding "Speech discerned as the vowels and consonants is recitation": the vowels and the consonants are the cause from which all mantras arise, and the fact that all the mantras one recites arise from them is the meaning of "speech is recitation." "Just as the father attained bliss": glorious Heruka is the father, the source of all. "He attained bliss" refers to the bliss of the awakening

mind; because it is attained from elvaṃ, it says "attained bliss." Likewise the yogin too, by constantly familiarizing himself with the bliss of elvaṃ, attains the accomplishment of Heruka, and so it says "eats." Regarding "This bliss by which one dies": "dying" is taught in a hidden way, concealed from outsiders. It means "causing to expand," that is, in actuality, the bliss in which the awakening mind has expanded with the taste of bliss. Regarding "Through meditative concentration on that bliss, and through speech, one is freed": by making the mind one-pointed on such bliss, one is freed from the three realms; this is the meaning of what is called the accomplishment of the Great Seal (mahāmudrā).

In another sense, "Just as the father obtained bliss" means this: the father of the generation of the mind set on awakening is the master. Just as that vajra master obtained the accomplishment born of consummate bliss, so the yogin, having received his pith instructions, obtains the accomplishment born of bliss; and so it says, "Likewise one eats one's own bliss."

As for "dying": maraṇa, that is, dying. Just as the dying mind becomes unified, so one is to take up the accomplishment of bliss. Alternatively, it is called maraṇa in the sense of expanding: by gathering the mind into one upon such bliss, one should make it expand. As for "by which one dies," the accomplishment expanded through such bliss is what is called "this bliss." The meaning is that such bliss is obtained by constantly abiding in great bliss.

This is the explanation of the fifth chapter.

In the sixth chapter, the meaning is that it teaches the conduct of going from the near shore of saṃsāra to the far shore of nirvāṇa. "Having attained a little warmth" means this: for that yogin there are signs of two kinds, outer and inner. Scents such as camphor arising from below, and sounds such as those of geese, are the outer signs. The inner signs are as given in the commentary itself. Subtle signs arise: this refers to the arising of lessened conceptual thought, a lessened share of the afflictions, little appetite for food, less sleep and the like, keen dream signs, and so forth. After that, with conceptual thought lessened, one should keep the higher modes of deportment free of anything people could reproach.

"Having attained accomplishment, as one wishes" means that when the signs of accomplishment have appeared, then, in order to enter upon the great practice, "taking the lower mudrā, one practices." "If one does not find a vajra maiden": that is, a maiden of the vajra family, a ḍombī (a woman of the

Ḍomba caste). If one does not have such a one, it may also be done with one of one's own deity's family, that is, it should be done with one of the vajra family and the others mentioned above; or else with another family, the lotus family and so on. The rest is easy to understand.

Regarding "Having made the gift of the body": one gives one's body to the noble ones and to all beings. Then one should begin the conduct of mantra. Regarding

"Through the distinction of fortunate and unfortunate,
one should not give gifts in this way,"

the meaning is that one does not give away one's body and so forth for the sake of a single sentient being. The rest is easy to understand. Regarding

"The disciple who has accomplished the practice,
endowed with the light of perfect wisdom,
bows down before the guru,"

the meaning is that even when the master has not attained accomplishment and the disciple has, if the disciple does not prostrate to the guru and so forth, he falls and degenerates.

This is the explanation of the sixth chapter.

Now I shall explain the seventh chapter. In it, the signs of yogins and of outsiders are examined. "Showing one finger" means showing the forefinger. "Showing two fingers" means showing the two, the forefinger and the middle finger. As for "The banner, and the weapon-slain too," "the banner" is the flesh of a dead man hung on a tree; one gathers this together with the flesh of those slain by weapons, and samta means "eat." Alternatively, vatavartan: if one sees the signs of one born seven times, such as seven shadows appearing, the meaning is that one should now make the samtavarti a substance for practice. Doing it now, too, is once the signs have appeared: when, after the signs of accomplishment have appeared, it is done with great compassion, the meaning is that it is done by the principal one and that compassion is generated. The rest is easy to understand, so I have not written it down.

"The syllable śrī is nondual wisdom" refers to the wisdom in which all phenomena are without intrinsic nature and are luminous. "The syllable he, cause and so forth" means this: it is taught that whatever, for want of such understanding, is conceived as cause and as agent arises from outer and inner dependent origination and is not established through any essential nature. Regarding "The syllable ru is free from arrangement": arrangement is to be

understood in terms of all phenomena being free from one and many. "The syllable kā abides nowhere" means: knowing visible phenomena to be nirvāṇa, and since there is nothing to adopt or reject, one abides in nothing whatever; so it is said. "Vajra Skull Cup" is the name of that practitioner who abides in the observance of Heruka and holds a vajra and a skull cup in his hands.

Regarding
"Of whatever kinds of beings
the wise one eats the flesh,
each such sentient being comes under his power,"
the meaning is this: if one buys, as the practitioner's substance, flesh of elephants and the like that one has not killed and that is blameless, from animals that died naturally or were killed by others and taken from a shop, and makes offerings with it, those sentient beings attain the higher realms and awakening. Alternatively, "beings," that is, those born and going, are the buddhas in whom wisdom has been born, and the meaning is that through compassion they go forth in different bodies for the benefit of others. "The wise one" means knowing that they are born from wisdom. "Eats" is said because one is nondual with them. "That sentient being" means that Heruka comes under one's power, that is, one obtains his accomplishment. This explanation does not follow the literal wording. The intended meanings have been explained; what is concealed is explained, as appropriate, in connection with the Mother.

This is the explanation of the seventh chapter.

Now the eighth chapter teaches the maṇḍala of the yoginīs. "Meditative concentration on the bhaga in the sphere of space" is connected with "triangle," which comes below. The rest is easy to understand, so I have not written it down. "The two rings" means: in the center of the house produced by generating Mahendra (the earth disk) and the rest, one should make an eight-petaled lotus. At its center is Nairātmyā. On the petals of the four directions, the four, Vajrā, Gaurī, Vārāhī, and Ḍākinī, are arranged in order, and in the four intermediate directions four skull cups (kapāla) filled with the awakening mind and so forth are placed. Its outer ring is made an eight-petaled lotus, and on it one places Gaurī, Caurī, Vetālī, Ghasmarī, Pukkasī, Śavarī, Caṇḍālī, and Ḍombī. At the eastern and western gates one places the two, Khecarī and Bhūcarī. The meaning is that these are of the nature of saṃsāra, appearing as colors and as signs, while ultimately, being without intrinsic nature, they also appear as the nature of nirvāṇa. The rest is

easy to understand, so I have not written it down.

"The other is explained as triangular" refers to the outer ring of that celestial palace, the queen's bhaga. In its center one places fifteen preta seats. "These are moons" means: on the central hub, upon a moon, one places two sets of the sixteen great ā letters. There, as the kāli, one places forty-two: in addition to the thirty-two great kā letters, ya ra la lva, śa ṣa sa ha, and the two, dhaḍa. That becomes the sun. In actuality, āli is the moon, that is, the nature of skillful means, and kāli is the sun, that is, the nature of wisdom.

Regarding "Then, the sun pressing down": the light of the moon, outshone by the light of the sun, does not appear, and because the two have become one, it appears as the sun itself. The meaning is that from the two great blisses, the vowels and the consonants (āli kāli), the moon and the sun become one, and that from the nonduality of these two they become Gaurī and the others described below. Here the moon is the sign of mirror-like wisdom, and the sun disk, the nonduality of the two, is the sign of the wisdom of equality.

As for "on the seven-seven," it is said that this refers to the sun's having seven horses. Some masters, however, say that of the fifteen deities, the fourteen goddesses placed on the lotus and at the gates abide there, and they connect this with "the sun is seven-seven." Those two are the wisdom of equality.

Regarding "One places the seed of one's own deity": the meaning is that one places the syllables of the goddesses and their hand emblem, the copper knife. That is of the nature of discriminating wisdom. The completely perfected body is of the nature of all-accomplishing wisdom. "Having become the five bodies" means that it has come about from five: the moon, the sun, the syllable, the hand emblem, and the completely perfected body. The learned have explained such a rite.

"The vowels and consonants joined in union" means this: arising from the two, the vowels and consonants, in the manner of a complete body, it is of the nature of Vajrasattva. It is to be construed thus: it arises in the manner of a complete body and does not arise from letters. This means that there is no need actually to generate the principal deity from hūṃ, the retinue from phaṭ, and so forth.

Regarding
"Arisen from the reflected image of the sentient being,
he is meditated on as lord of the maṇḍala;
the son's face, the marks, and so on,

moon, jewel, precious light,"
the masters explain this differently. The paṇḍita Ratnākaraśānti says: the mind of the sentient being appears as a five-pronged vajra, the very nature of the lord of the maṇḍala of the mind vajra; and from that the "son's face," that is, the body of the central lord, is generated. Other masters say that "Arisen from the reflected image of the sentient being" refers to Vajrasattva himself; since he is the lord of the maṇḍala itself, it says "meditate on the lord." As for "the son's face, the marks, and so on," since Heruka arises from Vajrasattva, it says "the son's face." As for "moon, jewel, precious light," the moon is Vajrasattva, who is white; the jewel is Heruka, who is like a sapphire; and "precious light" means that both blaze with light. "Thus all arise complete": since they arise from the vowels and consonants, the meaning is that they are of the nature of wisdom and skillful means. The rest was taught above, so I have not written it here.

From "First one should meditate on her as black" up to "The sixth, white in form, by the yogin," the meaning is the goddesses who are the six: the five, form, sound, and so on, together with mind. Their colors are taught in a jumbled order. "Meditate on the first as black" is the goddess of phenomena (dharmas). "The second as white" is the goddess of the tangible. "The third, yellow" is the goddess of smell. "The fourth, green" is the goddess of taste. "The fifth, blue" is the goddess of sound. "The sixth, white in form" is to be connected with the goddess of form. What their nature is will come below.

"Meditate at the end of supreme joy" means that one focuses on space, which thus has passed beyond form, sound, and the rest, and beyond attachment, freedom from attachment, and the rest.

Regarding "The generation stage and the completion stage": the generation stage refers to what was taught above, from generating the celestial palace to placing the syllables at the heart, and generating everything from the principal deity to the gatekeepers. Completion is meditating on even those preceding as naturally luminous. "The two stages" refers to the two, generation and completion. Therefore the Tathāgata declared them to be twofold. In the great yoga tantra called the Guhyasamāja it says:
"The Dharma taught by the buddhas
is said to be of two kinds:
the stage of generation
and likewise the stage of completion."

Therefore the meaning is that these two tantras teach by sealing with the two stages. "Taught as the vajra Dharma" is to be construed with "was explained by Vajrasattva himself."

Having taught the generation stage up to this point, in order to teach the completion stage it says, "This sphere of space is the lotus," meaning that space itself is the Mother's bhaga. If one asks who realizes it, it says, "the wisdom bhaga":
"Since it possesses completely pure wisdom,
it is rightly explained as the wisdom bhaga."
So it is said.

"The meditative concentration of union" is the meditative concentration in which the vowels and consonants are nondual; in actuality it is to be connected with consummate joy. Since that itself is the wheel of great bliss, it is called "the wheel of great bliss."

Regarding "Divided into conventional and ultimate": the awakening mind is twofold. The conventional awakening mind is the melted moon. The ultimate awakening mind is consummate joy. Regarding "The seed and its bliss": the seed should be understood as the conventional and the bliss as the ultimate. Wisdom, too, is as above.

Regarding
"Because joy and the rest
are divided into four,"
joy, supreme joy, sublime joy, and consummate joy are the division into four. Thus it is said that those four stages, up to the culmination, are explained as the completion stage. The rest is easy to understand, so I have not written it down.

"The first joy is explained as existence" means that since the arising of the first joy is present in sentient beings, existence is produced from it. As for "thorough attachment," to know that very ground of attachment as unproduced is called nirvāṇa. Regarding
"The mere joy in the middle:
this is wholly free of the culmination,"
whatever is the intermediate joy is "the middle." Since it too does not conceive of the culmination, it is called "free." Its meaning, it is said, is found by no one.

If so, one may ask, through what does one who is liberated by mantra become liberated? The root text says, "Serving and honoring the guru through the continuity of means." Whoever has generated the mind set on unsurpassed awakening, is endowed with faith and diligence, has entered the maṇḍala and properly received the four empowerments, and guards the commitments without regard for body and life: such persons, having served and honored the guru at all times, obtain the pith instructions and only then realize it. Therefore it says, "oneself endowed with merit."

"The lowest is of subtle form" means that the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) and those of the Lesser Vehicle do not realize it. As for "the very state of the supreme," the meaning of "supreme" is one of sharp faculties: one whose mental continuum has been trained by great compassion and who by great wisdom realizes the ultimate truth without error. The middling is neither small nor great. Ordinary beings and the like, whose six faculties are distracted by the six objects, are called "others."

Regarding "The actions that are equal and alike": nondual is "equal," and having become concordant is "alike." Engaging in action that is thus equal and alike is called "action." "Constantly teaching reality" is meditation on the taste. That which is thus without equal or like is expressed, in its meaning as well, in the language of conduct; hence "it is called peerless." "Such a wheel" is explained in terms of the maṇḍala of the mantra practitioner. The rest is easy to understand.

Regarding
"Attachment, aversion, envy,
delusion, and pride likewise:
all of these, beside the supreme reality,
are not worth even a sixteenth part,"
for example, the sixteenth digit of the moon is something subtle that ordinary people do not perceive. Likewise, it says, these are not worth even a mere sixteenth part of the supreme reality, that is, of consummate joy, of suchness. Alternatively, the meaning is that all the enjoyments of the gods, attachment being Mahādeva (Śiva), aversion Viṣṇu, delusion Brahmā, envy the asuras, and so on, are not worth even a sixteenth part of the supreme reality, great bliss. Apply other intended meanings here as well, as appropriate.

Since its meaning actually arises from the dharmadhātu, the expanse of reality, it says "arisen from the dharmadhātu." Since its truth is equal to space,

it is "endowed with means." The rest is easy to understand, so I have not written it down.

"All the tenets of the Vedas" refers to all the established worldly paths. "Substances and so forth," together with "practices," are to be understood as practices such as fire offerings and torma offerings. It says, "Through these, existence goes round." "Those who do not know Hevajra" refers to the two above, and the meaning is that this is futile.

This is the explanation of the eighth chapter.

Now I shall explain the meaning of the ninth chapter. Regarding
"In whatever ways the world is bound,
from the bondage of those very things it is freed,"
"in whatever ways it is bound" means bound by the afflictions such as attachment. As for "it is freed from the bondage of those very things": for example, poison that has not been mastered by medicine and mantra kills, while poison that has been mastered becomes nectar. In just the same way, if the essential nature of attachment and the rest is not known as wisdom, the śrāvakas and others become bound; but since the yogin who knows it attains accomplishment, it says "it is freed." This is also found in the yoga tantra called the Śrīparamādya:
"Attachment, aversion, and delusion, the three,
become poison through grasping.
When the poison itself is pacified,
the poison is rendered poisonless.
When nectar is relied on step by step,
it becomes nectar itself."
So it says. And in the great yoga tantra called the Unfailing Accomplishment of Discipline it says:
"That by which the fool is bound,
by that the wise is wholly freed:
when one meditates on awakening thus,
all these are reversed.
That by which the deluded are bound
and come at last to Raurava, the Howling Hell,
by that very thing one is freed."
Since it says this, the meaning is that one who knows the afflictions as completely pure becomes free.

"The deluded world does not know reality" means that ordinary beings, the tīrthikas, and the tīrthikas within the Buddha's own fold do not know it; this is the meaning of "deluded." Since those mentioned above have not received the pith instructions on great bliss, it says "bereft of reality." Thus, if one has not received the guru's pith instructions and has not realized the meaning of reality, then, it says, "one does not attain accomplishment."

"For that reason": abandoning every notion of form, sound, and the rest as inert matter, permanent and everlasting, one knows them as luminous; and since "the existence of beings," that is, the mind that conceives of them, is also known as luminous, it says, "the existence of beings is wholly pure."

This is the explanation of the ninth chapter.

Now the meaning of the tenth chapter is explained. This chapter teaches the empowerment of disciples. The passage beginning "Then I shall rightly explain" is easy to understand, so I have not written it down. "And in the house of a bodhisattva" refers to the places where buddhas and bodhisattvas dwelt in the past; the meaning is that one should practice in actual places such as Vajrāsana (at Bodhgayā), Vulture Peak, and Mount Potala. Some say that it refers to a temple itself, since images of the bodies of buddhas and bodhisattvas reside there. In the great yoga tantra called the Highest Declaration, too, it says:

"In mountain ravines and on mountain peaks,
on the banks of great rivers,
on the shores of the great ocean,
by a lone tree, in a place of virtue,
in a shrine of the mātṛkās or a charnel ground,
or in various solitary places,
in temples and at stūpas,
in houses or at crossroads:
when the practitioner accomplishes the union,
it grants the fruit of every wish."

So it says. And in the great root tantra called the Glorious Guhyasamāja it says:

"In the reaches of a great wilderness,
in places utterly secluded,
and in solitary mountain regions,
if one practices meditative absorption (samādhi), one attains accomplishment."

Since it says this, yogins who have entered through the door of the great yoga tantras, when they perform the rites of the maṇḍala and so forth and when they engage in practice, practice in wildernesses, forest groves, and the like. If instead they perform the rites of the maṇḍala and so forth in towns, amid bustle, and the like, their commitments degenerate and they are born in the lower realms; they turn their backs on the great accomplishment and do not attain liberation. Therefore this very tantra also says, "In seclusion, such as a forest grove, and in the middle of a house, one should make the maṇḍala"; hence it is to be done in a house in the wilderness.

In general, then, as for the dwelling of practitioners of the great yoga: a yogin's dwelling is built in a wilderness, a remote borderland, or the like. It is built with three stories. The lower story should be made the place for offerings and other provisions. On the middle story are to be kept musical instruments such as drums, flutes, conches, and cymbals.

On top of that are placed yogins and yoginīs, canopies and banners, images, and so on, and in its center the maṇḍala, the offerings, and so forth; so it is said. Therefore this is connected with what this very tantra says:
"In the middle of the house, the maṇḍala:
the sublime maṇḍala is to be drawn."
"Its middle" means that it is to be made inside the upper story. The rest is easy to understand.

Regarding
"Through intimacy with that mudrā,
what then arises endowed with śukra,"
this means that that very goddess is properly blessed, union is entered, and the śukra is made to descend; the disciple should take it with his tongue in that very space, or, if he is someone quite unaccustomed, it should be poured into his mouth.

Regarding
"First comes what has the form of a cloud;
once it is accomplished, it is made like an illusion,"
the yogin, having first properly received empowerment in a place like the one described above, practices for a long time, and as the first sign of accomplishment, various lights and appearances like clouds arise. Through familiarity with that, it becomes like an illusion.

Regarding
"There, too, the culmination is like a dream,
just as one sees whether asleep or not asleep,"
one rests for a long time in consummate joy. For example, when one has dreamed in sleep of finding a treasure, on waking there is no actual thing, yet the image remains in the mind. Just so, whether asleep or not asleep, whether walking or sitting, at all times, the meaning is that one rests in meditative equipoise in consummate bliss.

Regarding
"Having seen the signs, one practices,
and the yoga of the mudrā is accomplished,"
by meditating thus for a long time, one is freed from all conceptual thought. The gradual appearance of the signs of attaining luminosity that are described in the tantra is "the yoga of the mudrā"; the meaning is what is called the accomplishment of the Great Seal. The rest is easy to understand.

Regarding
"Through the union of wisdom and means,
from that, earth is produced,"
at the time of entering union, the slight hardness that comes from the joining of the organs is the sign of earth; hence it says, "from that it is produced."

Regarding
"From the falling stream of the awakening mind,
it also becomes water,"
since the stream of the melting śaśi, the moon, is moist, it is called water.

Regarding "From friction fire arises," this refers to the heat of fire being produced at that juncture. The flowing of the stream is wind. Since the taste of bliss cannot be expressed by anything, it is space.

The bliss that comes from what arises in this way is not great bliss. As the great yoga sādhana called the Jñānasiddhi also says:
"The bliss arising from the two organs
base people declare to be reality;
but the Victors did not
call that great bliss.
The wisdom of all the sugatas,
which knows its own essential nature
and has become the chief of all bliss,

is explained as great bliss.
Yet that bliss is not to be abandoned,
for there is no bliss equal to passion;
it is to be offered to the Victors.
Enjoying all the objects of desire,
one should not hold them in contempt."
The meaning is that the bliss arising in this way is bliss, but not great bliss.

If one asks what, then, it is:
"What is produced by the culmination,
that is declared to be the culmination."
This refers to the nondual instant free from all conceptual thought. Regarding
"The one sole bliss of all
is declared by nature to be the culmination,"
as for "all" and "bliss," since it is free from all conceptual thought, it is called "free from all" and "sole." The meaning is that what is realized there is both the sole bliss and the culmination. If one asks what its actual nature is, it says, "Wholly free of the causes of mudrā": at the time of the culmination one does not conceive of mantra, mudrā, and the like, and so it says "free."

Regarding "By the yogin endowed with compassion and means," this means that one abides constantly, never separated from emptiness and great compassion. "The awakening mind" is the conventional and the ultimate mind. From the seed of one who has entered union with the intention of establishing all sentient beings in awakening, the body, the maṇḍala, and so forth arise; when it acts for the benefit of beings, it is the conventional awakening mind. Its bliss, free from all conceptual elaboration, is the ultimate great bliss; that is called the ultimate awakening mind.

In another sense, the body of Heruka, like the moon in water, appears as the nature of all things, and its guiding of beings by various means is compassion, the conventional awakening mind; ultimately, it refers to being free from all conceptual thought, like a master illusionist.

Alternatively, since that consummate great bliss is of the nature of wisdom and compassion joined as a pair, it is called the awakening mind. As the Noble Sūtra Taught by Vimalakīrti also says:
"What possesses both wisdom and compassion
is to be known as the awakening mind."

And the practice of the Five Stages (Pañcakrama) composed by the master Nāgārjuna also says:
"Having known wisdom and compassion as one,
and having made the mind certain,
this stage is the domain of the buddhas:
that is union (yuganaddha)."
Therefore, since that consummate great bliss is of the nature of wisdom and compassion, it is called the awakening mind.

For this, the practitioner should first call to mind the suffering of beginningless time, and, desiring the bliss of nirvāṇa, should completely abandon all busyness, regarding even sovereignty over a kingdom as suffering. Second, one should abandon any attitude that grasps even so much as a sesame seed as a real thing. Third, through faith in the ultimate truth, one should be without regard even for body and life. Thus one focuses in the manner of these three perceptions.

Accordingly, bhu means partaking of food: one is mindful of only that much and abandons all busyness, thinks of nothing at all as "austerity" or "observance," and focuses one-pointedly on the aim of one's own practice. su means sleeping. Since sleep is marked, for these consciousnesses, by ignorance, one makes it directly manifest: ignorance, which is like a hook, does not draw consciousness toward anything at all; one makes luminosity itself manifest and attends one-pointedly to the stainless essential nature. ku means going to the latrine in order to void excrement and urine: one is mindful of only that much and abandons busyness, does not dwell in thought on the nature of the body, feelings, the faculties, and so on, and practices without being distracted even for an instant from the aim one is accomplishing. This is the meaning.

One lets the mind abide in that for an instant, a day, a month, a year, and so on, and it is spontaneously accomplished; at that point there is no need for secret mantra, austerities, fire offerings, and the like. This is the meaning.

Regarding "In brief, it has the character of the collected mind": just as, for example, the dying mind becomes unified and its conceptual thought diminishes, so that consummate mind, too, is free of conceptual thought; that which has the character of space is called "the collected mind." Since in such a state, in every mode of conduct, the five outer awarenesses flow into it, it

says, "That is also recitation." Luminosity, free of all conceptual thought, is the heart of the maṇḍala; to enter it together with nondual wisdom and become indivisible from it is what is meant by "That is also entering the maṇḍala."

This is the explanation of the tenth chapter.

Now I shall explain the eleventh chapter. Regarding "The level gaze, fierce, fixed on the forehead": the eyes, the breath, and so on are means of practice. Heruka's two eyes looking straight ahead is "level." "Fixed on the forehead" means looking upward in the direction of the forehead. "At all times it is taught as the felling gaze" means that by looking in this way the target of the rite falls to the ground.

Regarding
"Both eyeballs are turned to the left;
looking to the left is the gaze of subjugation,"
the meaning is that by looking to the left with both eyes, the target comes under one's power. The meaning is that by looking to the right, too, the target of the rite comes under one's power. And by gazing with both eyes at the tip of the nostrils, the rite of suppression is accomplished. That is practice by means of the four gazes.

As for practice by means of the breath: sending the breath outward makes the target fall; holding it brings the target under one's power; drawing it inward summons. To show their meaning clearly, it says, "The felling one, upon the essences of trees": one draws in the essences of the trees one is working on. Holding the breath brings under one's power the flowers one is working on. Drawing in the breath gathers the essences of the vajra tree, the śrikista. The meaning is that if one endowed with power practices this, it is accomplished in six months.

Regarding
"Have no doubt about this:
the magic of the buddhas is not to be pondered,"
the meaning is that these are the magic of the buddhas, and one should not think, "Will I attain them or not?" "The four gazes" refers to the four above. The rest is easy to understand, so I have not written it down.

"Having gathered na and the rest" refers to the commitment substances to be eaten. "The first meat" is dog's flesh. na is human flesh. ga is cow's flesh. ha is elephant flesh. "The final meat" is horse flesh. The meaning is that if one eats these, accomplishment comes about.

"The seven lineages": if one eats the flesh of one born seven times, who has seven shadows, after he has died, there is accomplishment. Alternatively, this one is called paśu, or "great beast," and rites are accomplished with his flesh and so on. His signs are seven shadows appearing, a body with the fragrance of camphor, excrement and urine that smell of musk, clear faith in the Three Jewels, possession of all the perfections, and so on. Some say that this means killing him, but it does not, for the Highest Declaration Tantra says:

"When a yogin sees one such as this,
since this is not a rite of killing,
he does not die, he is not burned,
nor is he left to be eaten
by vicious creatures of any kind, or by anyone at all.
Unseen by night,
he is the supreme lord of invisibility.
When a mantrin has recognized one such as this,
he asks for it himself and makes use of the gift."

Since it says this, various accomplishments arise through his flesh, bones, and so on; in particular, they are present in the heart, the navel, and the crown of the head.

As for the meats mentioned above, too, when they come from animals that died naturally, or have been bought by a patron from low-caste people, butchers, and the like, eating them delights the holy ones. Otherwise, if one kills, doing harm to sentient beings, or, thinking, "Various accomplishments will arise," obtains the flesh by such means as having them killed, and eats it, that becomes a grave fault. As the Sandhivyākaraṇa Tantra says:

"'I am a yogin,' they say,
yet they practice this Dharma with deceit
and kill other living creatures.
They do not know the commitments.
Such yogins, deficient in yoga,
such mantrins, will not attain accomplishment."

This very tantra also says:

"Through the practice of taking life
comes the gravest breach of the commitments.
If one does even the least harm to sentient beings,
the accomplishment of the mudrā will not be attained.
Therefore, in every way,

one should avoid harming sentient beings."
Since it says this, the meaning is that one should take the substances described above. The passage beginning "I shall explain the practice of Kurukullā" is easy to understand, so I have not written it down.

This is the explanation of the eleventh chapter.

From here on, the latter part of the Two Examinations, the later tantra, is explained. Of it, the explanation of the first chapter is presented. Since the rite of consecrating images is taught here, and the way into it is clear, understand it as appropriate.

Now the explanation of the second chapter is presented. In it the rite of the wisdom and gnosis empowerment (prajñājñāna) is taught. Regarding
"Blessed One, of all phenomena,
just as with a gourd in the ocean,"
this is to be construed with "wishing to go from the ocean of saṃsāric things to the far shore of the suchness of phenomena." For example, although the ocean is vast and deep, a person skilled in means who sets out riding on two gourds lashed side by side gradually reaches the far shore. Just so, how is the vast accomplishment that arises from the dharmadhātu to be attained? This is what was asked.

The Blessed One declared:
"Through Nairātmyā, oneself in yoga,
or else in union as glorious Heruka."
The meaning is that if one abides and meditates, with a mind not distracted for even an instant, upon entering into Nairātmyā and upon the illusion-like body of glorious Heruka, one attains accomplishment. Therefore this is connected with what the root text says:
"Not for an instant does the mind
dwell elsewhere: such is one who desires accomplishment."
The rest is easy to understand, so I have not written it down.

Regarding
"By practicing once with the knowledge consort (vidyā),
the signs arise immediately,"
the meaning is that by resting in meditative equipoise with the wisdom consort (prajñā), gnosis arises from consummate joy; that is, accomplishment arises. "For one month, practice in secret": it says one practices in any month

whatever. This is the method of taking up accomplishment once the signs have appeared.

"Where no mudrā is to be found,
to the mantrin whom kindness has touched:
'Take the mudrā named such and such.'"

This means: if, once one's mind has been purified and one is on the very verge of accomplishment, one has no mudrā of one's own, then, since the yogins point out a mudrā, saying, "Her name is such and such," one should take her without conceptual thought and practice.

On
"Having examined one's own strength,
one does not practice for enjoyment, it is taught":
one practices because one's own mind has been trained, conceptual thought has been exhausted, and one has received the instructions; one does not practice for the sake of sensual enjoyment. If one does practice for the sake of desire, it is described as "a terrifying form," which means being born as a sentient being in the hells and the like. In the Extensive Commentary on the Vairocana Māyājāla, too, it says:

"If otherwise a craving arises
for the enjoyments of desire,
the mantrin, through lack of training,
will be born in the Avīci hell."

Another text says that when both that knowledge consort, the companion for attaining the accomplishment of Mahāmudrā, and oneself, the practitioner, possess empowerment and samaya, have thoroughly trained minds, and have received the instructions, then if they worship and practice, it becomes accomplishment. Otherwise, if one recites the mantra as mere words and practices it hypocritically, one ruins oneself in the lower realms and so forth, and brings others to ruin as well. So the meaning is that one should practice and worship properly.

It was asked:
"In union with the yoginī Nairātmyā,
what distinguishes the mudrās?"
"Mudrā and mudrā, the two."
On this: the yogin who practices with Nairātmyā does not achieve accomplishment through wisdom alone, without method, nor through method

without wisdom. Therefore, since the accomplishment of Mahāmudrā arises from these two as taught, it says, "mudrā and mudrā, the two."

Well then, if one asks how accomplishment arises in the maṇḍala of goddesses alone described above, the answer is:

"Having abandoned the woman's form,
one transforms it into the Blessed One's form."

This means abandoning the goddess's form and making it into the form of method. That is, the two breasts are given up and joined at the opening of the lotus, so that it becomes the vajra, and the other becomes the testicles, as in "on the two sides, with bells." Then the whole form becomes Heruka: that is the meaning. In short, if one practices by such a method, it becomes accomplishment.

If one asks what qualities this achieves, the meaning is: freed from birth and destruction, "through wisdom and method, it cannot be overpowered." Therefore, because method puts an end to the saṃsāra of birth, and wisdom crosses beyond the saṃsāra of fear, this is the meaning of "ender of existence"; and for that reason it is called "fearless." Thus the upshot is that through accomplishment by the two, method and wisdom, one is freed from the things that accord with birth in saṃsāra, and perfect, complete buddhahood is accomplished.

From "Through the yoga of the generation stage" up to "one has practiced the yoga constantly," the generation stage dispels the conception that the arising of things is permanent. As for the meaning of the words, it is clear from the tantra, so I have not written it out.

Now the method of empowerment is taught. The passage beginning "Bliss is black" teaches that there is no thing whatever apart from great bliss. "Vajragarbha asked" is the compiler's phrase. When he asked, "Blessed One, if everything arises from the supreme, sublime great bliss, what is to be done with the generation stage taught above?" the Blessed One declared: "O you of fervent faith, what you say is true and yet not true: without relying on the generation stage, there is no completion stage apart from it. Therefore:

From a nonexistent body, what bliss could there be?
Bliss could not be spoken of.
Beings, embodied and pervaded by the pervader,
are pervaded by bliss."

So he taught. Bliss arises in dependence on the body; it does not arise from what is nonexistent. That is why he taught "beings are pervaded by bliss" and the rest.

"Whoever is overpowered by laziness" means that the lazy, whose minds are distracted, do not contemplate such great bliss, because they have fallen under the sway of busyness.

That triangular dharmamudrā is called "the jewel casket," because from it arise the immeasurable qualities, with their tenfold distinctions, of the buddhas and the rest.

"The very nature of ultimate joy" refers to the joy that has left the third behind. As for supreme joy and intense joy, through familiarity with them, just as a lamp raised in the darkness shines very brightly, the light of joy dispels the darkness of conceptual thought about things, and one attains the supreme accomplishment: that is the meaning. On "The consonants, likewise": the upshot is that just as accomplishment is attained through the joys, so too accomplishment arises from the letters, the vowels and consonants. The remaining examples and their meanings are easy to understand.

"Worldly beings are bound by desire itself" means this: those who are bound in saṃsāra by the desire of sexual union, having obtained the instructions by serving and honoring the guru, practice in accordance with the joys, and thereby the fire of desire that brings birth in saṃsāra is quenched by purified desire, the nondual gnosis, and it becomes the accomplishment of Mahāmudrā.

If one asks whose domain this is:

"This very contemplation of reversal
is not for Buddhists or for non-Buddhists (tīrthikas)."

This means it is not the domain of those of the śrāvaka family who believe in real entities, who are inclined to inferior views and conduct, and who have turned their backs on the great accomplishment.

"The elements, fivefold in their own forms,
become the five great blisses":
this means that in great bliss, the melting of the moon, the five elements are complete, and so it is called "the five blisses." The upshot is that even these five are but a single entity of bliss.

As for the passage beginning "Through the union of wisdom and method": at the instant that wisdom and method enter into equipoise, the five elements, the five afflictions, the five families, and so forth are completed instantaneously; this should be understood as fits each case.

This is the explanation of the second chapter.

Now the explanation of the third chapter is set out. "Declaring the rites of all the tantras" means that it clearly teaches the meditative absorptions and the instructions of all the tantras: the method tantras such as the glorious Guhyasamāja, and the wisdom tantras such as the tantra of the Highest Declaration. More particularly, it concerns the yoginī tantras, for it serves to settle definitively all the tantras such as the wisdom tantra called the Ḍākinījālasaṃvara.

Since it teaches its vow, empowerment, and so forth, this is the meaning of "Therein I shall explain the vow (saṃvara)."

"The vow is all the buddhas;
it abides fully in evaṃ."
This means that the vow in its aspects is all the buddhas, and the buddhas are gathered in evaṃ: e is the mother and vaṃ is the father, while the bindu is the awakening mind (bodhicitta), and that mind is said to abide in the bhaga. Moreover, in its intended meaning this is explained as actually the three: the accomplisher, the means of accomplishment, and what is to be accomplished. The accomplisher is the yogin, who is himself of the nature of the enjoyment body (sambhogakāya). The means of accomplishment is the mother, e, the essential nature of the expanse of reality (dharmadhātu). What is to be accomplished is nondual gnosis, which corresponds to the bindu. One on whom the master has bestowed such instruction and conferred empowerment is said to bring about great bliss alone.

On "This which is e is the manifold body": it is the letter e, that very space which has become the nature of all things, the essential nature of the expanse of reality. On "Adorned in the center with vaṃ": in the center of that space is vaṃ, which is to say that method and the awakening mind abide there.

On "The casket of buddha jewels": since it is both a buddha and a jewel, it is the "buddha jewel." Being adorned, like a casket, with the major and minor marks, or possessing the sublime qualities of a celestial palace, it is "the casket of buddha jewels." In reality it is the jewel of all the buddhas of the ten directions; the meaning is that it is the source of all great qualities. Since that

abode is the very nature of all bliss and joy, this is the meaning of "arising from it."

"Distinguished by the division of moments" means that since the moment of ultimate gnosis is born from the evaṃ above, the upshot is "It abides fully in evaṃ." This, moreover, is taught by the four beginning with the one called "variety" (vicitra). Here, the four beginning with variety, the four joys, the four empowerments, and so on, that is, the twelve great points of instruction and the rest, should be learned from the word of the guru.

Vajragarbha asked:
"Where do the samayas abide?
What are the vows?"
The Blessed One declared:
"You must kill living beings,
you must speak false words as well,
you must take what is not given,
and consort with the women of others."

Concerning this passage and what follows, some people here take the words literally and engage in wrong conduct such as taking life. But taking life is the very grossest even among deeds that are reprehensible by nature. It is taught to be the chief cause of the lower realms; it is a great nonvirtue; and it is the root of opposition to the Teacher's doctrine. Therefore one should understand that taking life is found nowhere in the entire word of the Sugata (the Buddha).

Taking life comes from certain teachings of the non-Buddhists. In the past, some brahmins who were fond of meat, because they wanted meat, made effigies of wild animals, livestock, and so on, and so beguiled the eyes of others; in the end they actually slaughtered livestock, and they composed scriptures declaring that those very animals would be reborn as gods. Other non-Buddhists, who practice purity, keep ascetic observances, and settle in meditative concentration, hold that this is not Dharma. Indeed, it is well known that when the sage Vyāsa engaged his own son, the brahmin youth Śuka, in a sacrifice, Śuka said this to his father:

"Having raised the sacrificial post and slain the beasts,
having made a pact of blood,
if by this one goes to the higher realms,
by what then does one go to hell?"

By saying this and more, he refuted him. That being so, how could those who have entered the Buddha's teaching count it as a path in accord with the Dharma?

The commentary on the Guhyasamāja composed by the master Śrīsena says: "As for what is called taking life there, whatever brings about the attainment of the meditative absorption of emptiness, in which the vajra of gnosis renders the entire realm of sentient beings beyond apprehension, is what is here explained as taking life." And the ṭīkā on that same work also says: "Life (prāṇa) is the great wind, whose characteristic is to move constantly. Blocking and restraining it is what is called taking life, not the killing of sentient beings." So the intent of this passage, too, is that restraining life and exertion (prāṇāyāma), withdrawing the mind inward, and resting in equipoise in the signless meditative absorption is what is called taking life.

The Commentary on the Difficult Points of the Guhyasamāja, composed by the master Ānandagarbha, also says: "There, attaining the meditative absorption of emptiness, in which the vajra of gnosis renders the entire realm of sentient beings without entity, is what taking life means." The Guhyasamāja commentary called the Illuminating Lamp (Pradīpoddyotana) also explains: "'If one kills all sentient beings' means destroying them by rendering them emptiness." And the Sandhivyākaraṇa Tantra says:

"One whose aggregates and the rest are without entity,
made so by the mind through calm abiding as well,
is one who takes life,
abiding in the supreme vehicle."

The root tantra called the glorious Guhyasamāja says:

"If, with a vajra secret such as this,
one kills all sentient beings,
in the buddhafields of Akṣobhya
one will be born as a child of the Victors."

This means destroying, with the gnosis of emptiness just explained, the view of the transitory collection (satkāyadṛṣṭi) and the rest that belong to the mindstreams of oneself and others, and meditating on them as unborn. The result that is taught is birth in the buddhafield of Akṣobhya. Therefore the meaning is that if, through this yoga of meditative concentration, one cultivates the meditative absorption characterized by not apprehending body and mind, one will be born in the buddhafield of Akṣobhya.

If some think that taking life means liberating sentient beings from saṃsāra, it is not so. To generate the resolve for unsurpassed awakening, gather immeasurable accumulations, and then bring all sentient beings out of the ocean of saṃsāra onto the dry land of awakening: that is what is called liberating. It does not refer to killing. If one could liberate sentient beings from saṃsāra by killing them, it would be fitting for the buddhas and the mighty bodhisattvas to work for the benefit of beings through the practice of killing alone. Yet nowhere is anything of the kind taught, and nowhere have they done it. So the meaning of the word "liberate" is not killing either. Therefore, to count as Dharma this, which is bound up with taking life, contradicts the whole of the Buddha's teaching, and so it cannot serve as a path to awakening. But enough elaboration; I shall return to the main text itself.

Therefore the tantra itself teaches:
"Life is explained to be the mind;
the one-pointed mind is the taking of life."
To know, with the weapon of wisdom, that one's own luminous mind, the minds of all sentient beings, and all phenomena are unborn: this is what is called taking life.

Because speaking false words and the like is reprehensible by nature, it is contrary to the noble path; so this is not actual lying. To teach that all outer and inner phenomena, comprising the vessel-world and its inhabitants, are not made by any maker, but arise dependently, like an illusion, relying on causes and conditions, and are deceptive by nature: that is speaking falsehood. This is stated in the Sandhivyākaraṇa Tantra:

"One who teaches the inner and likewise the outer
as dependent arising of two kinds
is one who delights in false speech,
a yogin who abides in the abodeless."

To speak in this way is speaking falsehood.

By meditating on the entire realm of sentient beings as generated into the nature of vajra body, speech, and mind, one seizes and clears away the wealth that is the conceptual thought of the minds and mental factors of the entire realm of sentient beings: this is stealing the wealth of others. This is stated in the Sandhivyākaraṇa Tantra:

"The gnosis of the perfect buddhas
is to be known as the wealth;
whatever way there is of seizing it
is held to be craving for the wealth of others."

The meditation of perfect union with all the goddesses, as numerous as the particles of all the world systems, is constantly delighting in desire. The supreme woman is the Blessed Mother, the Perfection of Wisdom (Prajñāpāramitā), who is the mother of all the Tathāgatas; by another form of her name she is called Mahāmudrā. It was with becoming mingled as one with them in mind that consorting with the women of others was taught. And it is taught:

"Whoever, reality being one,
is ever united with suchness,
that being delights in desire
and becomes sublime in the supreme practice."

Therefore this very tantra also says:

"'I shall liberate the world':
this too is spoken of by the word 'falsehood.'
The consort's śukra is taking what is not given;
the women of others are one's own goddess."

Since it says this, these words such as "taking life" were spoken with a hidden intent; the meaning is not as the words literally say. The rest is easy to understand, so I have not written it down.

"The hero should eat everything" means eating everything equally, clean and unclean, good and bad. "The five colors (varṇa) are to be enjoyed equally" refers to the royal caste, the brahmin caste, the merchant caste, the low caste, and the ḍombī caste.

On "The five nectars, molasses, and liquor": the five nectars are the five substances. Molasses is blood. The poison of liquor is the impurities of the sense organs, such as the eyes. Neem is skin. Hearth water is warmth. Sour is the flower. Sweet is urine. Astringent is flesh. Bitter is blood. Pungent is fat. Salty is marrow. Bone is grease. Fragrance is the nails. Water is the companion. Blood is meant literally. This is the meaning of "These should be eaten without conceptual thought."

"Wearing a garment of various patterns" refers to a many-colored garment, taken from the clothing of corpses, that covers the private parts. The "ornament of earth" refers to smearing the body with the great ash. "Flowers born from the abode of hungry ghosts" means, in short, tying on one's head a garland of flowers that had been tied on a corpse and thrown away. The rest is easy to understand, so I have not written it down.

The passage beginning "kalika are the five buddhas" refers to that very ultimate joy; the rest should be understood as appropriate.

This is the explanation of the third chapter.

Now the fourth chapter is explained: it teaches song, dance, signs, and so on.

On
"Through the two, song and dance,
one should perform the supreme dance and sing the song":
the song is sung in the form of Amitābha, and the dance is performed in the form of Heruka.

The smell of garlic and the like are signs that accomplishment has been attained. Garlic is meant literally; sweet fragrances such as camphor arise. Likewise there are clear sounds and the like, and the jackal cries "ku." The signs of the mudrā are made clear in the tantra.

"A practitioner who does not know will not truly succeed" means this: to practice by joining the five afflictions, aversion and the rest, with the five families is to join each with the family that matches it. Just as, for example, a mantra that dispels fever is called a "fever mantra," so whatever gnosis serves as the antidote to them is called by those names. Therefore, by way of shared qualities, the five afflictions, purified through qualities that accord with the five aggregates, appear as the five families. Because it hates and destroys the cognition that apprehends things dualistically, as existence and nonexistence, permanence and annihilation, apprehended and apprehender, and so on, it is called aversion: it is nondual gnosis. Therefore it is aversion purified, and so it is said, "Akṣobhya is Nairātmyā, the mudrā of aversion."

Thus, just as delusion is characterized by being benighted and not discriminating particulars, so the gnosis that realizes the expanse of reality with certainty also does not discriminate particulars, since it realizes all phenomena as one taste. Because it resembles delusion in this respect, abiding like inert matter, delusion purified is Vairocana; this is connected with

"In reality, Vajrā is the mudrā of delusion."

Jealousy is being unable to bear the excellent fortune of others and wanting oneself to be endowed with prosperity.

Here, however, it is the wish to perform the deeds of a buddha for the benefit of beings by oneself alone, without relying on anyone else. Jealousy purified, whose characteristic is activity, is Amoghasiddhi. This is the meaning of "In reality, Gaurī is the mudrā of jealousy."

Desire is characterized by attachment and clinging to any thing whatever. Here, being attached to the ripening and liberation of all sentient beings, or clinging to the true meaning and never letting it go, is desire; and that is the very essence of desire purified, Amitābha. This is the meaning of "In reality, Vārī is the mudrā of desire."

Pride is of the nature of conceit. Pride purified, by virtue of regarding oneself as equal to all the buddhas, is Ratnasambhava. This is the meaning of what is said: "In reality, the Ḍākinī is the mudrā of avarice."

Therefore this does not refer to relying on desire and the rest, which are the domain of saṃsāra and afflictive by nature. Here, through the antidote, the understanding of the purified expanse of reality and so forth, they are freed from their former nature, and the arising of another, distinctive realization becomes a doorway to the supramundane Dharma. It is like one who has mastered a mantra against poison: he renders the potency of the poison ineffective, and when he takes the poison, another potency arises by which it becomes medicine. That is why it is taught in this way. Otherwise, these are the complete causes of saṃsāra and the very poison that leads to the lower realms and the like; and since an inversion of cause and effect is a contradiction, it is impossible that pure gnosis should arise and awakening be attained by relying on them. Therefore, only when they are held by wisdom free of elaboration that has become powerful, like a mastered mantra against poison, do they become the sublime method, and not otherwise.

Thus, since the distinct five families appear from the antidotes to those afflictions and from the nature of the five gnoses that are their purification, it was with this in mind that it was said:

"All the buddhas are born from desire;
likewise they are born from delusion and aversion."

The Śrīparamādya Tantra also says:

"Desire, aversion, and delusion, these three,
become poison through grasping.
When the poison itself is fully pacified,
the poison has been made nonpoisonous."

The Ratnakūṭa Sūtra also says: "Kāśyapa, it is like this: poison controlled by mantra and medicine, for example, cannot cause death. Kāśyapa, in the same way, the poison controlled by gnosis and skill in means cannot make one fall into ruin."

Thus this teaching that the very purity of the five afflictions is the five Tathāgatas is also simply the Sugata's skill in means; it does not mean that they are accompanied by afflictions. Therefore the tantra says:

"He whose nature is free from desire,
yet for those to be trained is wrathful to the wrathful
and to the desirous appears as though desirous,
abiding in supreme awakening: to him I bow."

Moreover, the Blessed One has gone to the very end of completely abandoning the afflictions together with their habitual tendencies. Even so, for the sake of certain disciples, he dwells surrounded by supramundane goddesses, such as a host of consorts, and appears to be enjoying the pleasures of desire and the like. If one asks with what in mind he does so: the gods, such as Kāmeśvara (the Lord of Desire), together with their own wives and hosts of harem women, are exceedingly arrogant on account of their sensual enjoyments, thinking that no one is superior to them. In order to dispel their arrogance and bring them into the teaching, he emanates the qualities of the Tathāgatas, the four immeasurables, the six perfections, and so on, in the form of goddesses, and shows himself endowed with sensual enjoyments far surpassing those of the gods. Seeing this, the gods become utterly disenchanted with their own saṃsāra, and, their pride gone, a longing for the Tathāgata's excellence arises in them. When they ask, "By what means can these be attained?", he sets them, as the means of attaining them, to going for refuge in the Three Jewels, generating the resolve for awakening, and so on, and so causes them to attain those supramundane qualities.

Again, the Great Samaya Tantra says:

"For these sons of the gods
who ever dwell in desire,
and for others who are desirous,

the maṇḍala of great delight is taught."

Accordingly, this is like luring out a puppy with a puppy. To people in whom desire predominates, in order that they abandon desire, he appears as if enjoying a host of consorts of surpassing excellence and the objects of desire. Thereby he makes them weary of ordinary desire, sets their minds yearning and longing for the unsurpassed riches of the Tathāgata, and has them examine the nature of these. Being thus freed from the conceptual thought that clings to them and grasps at signs, they are gradually freed from the afflictions, and he brings their accumulation of qualities to completion. Therefore the Vajrajāla Tantra says:

"For beings deluded by desire,
it is desire itself that dispels it."

Here the purification of desire is taught at length in order to train those born from the womb, and because this tantra teaches only union with the wisdom consort; it is by virtue of a hidden intent that it is taught in this way. Those who imagine that the Tathāgata acts with desire, and grasp this in a way that does not accord with the proper approach, have not understood the intent. This is simply what he does through skillful means in order to train beings. As the Lokānuvartana (Conforming to the World) also says:

"From the time of Dīpaṃkara on,
the Tathāgata has been free of desire,
yet he speaks of Rāhula as his son:
this is conforming to the world."

This concludes the digression; I shall return to the main text itself. It teaches, "Pukkasī is the mudrā of aversion."

On "The rest should be abandoned with effort": it says that the three channels are supreme, while the rest, the twenty-nine channels, are not needed. That is because it also says, "The sixteenth part is not needed at all."

"The sixteenth part" means a channel even subtler than the twenty-nine, which no one perceives and which can perform no function at all. For the tantra says: "Why? Because it does not perform the function of the basis."

On
"The awakening mind, in continuous flow, is the moon,
having the nature of fifteen digits":

the awakening mind is like the moon of the fifteenth day in its character. Since it has the nature of great bliss, the meaning is that in reality it is realized by one who has a yoginī, and not by method alone.

"Because it is protected by bliss,
it is called by the name Sukhāvatī (the Blissful)."
This, and the rest, is easy to understand.

On "Green, of the fearless family": "green" means very beautiful. Because she has abandoned conceptual thought and possesses the samaya, she is called "of the fearless family."

"sihla and camphor truly arise": sihla is rakta (blood), and camphor is the awakening mind. In reality it refers to one endowed with these two.

"Having abandoned method and wisdom": pola is taken to mean method, and "abandoned" refers to it; kakkola is wisdom. The meaning is that if these two are abandoned, there is no accomplishment.

On "The wise one, having made great bliss": thus, one endowed with pola and kakkola produces great bliss. Then, of the camphor that arises from the bliss of their nonduality, it says, "The wise should not discard the camphor." So the meaning is that one should not discard the melting bliss of the moon that arises from the bliss described above; if one discards it, there is no accomplishment.

Well then, if one asks how it should be taken: not with the hand. As it says, "It is not with an oyster shell or a conch cup." It is not taken by such means, but with the understanding of all the buddhas. On "Having taken the deathless with the jihva": that very nectar should be drunk with the tongue.

On "Strength will surely increase": the meaning is that by drinking it, even if accomplishment is not attained in an instant, one's luster, radiance, strength, and splendor will increase.

"The very nature of the first vowel" refers to a. Since that mind is of the nature of a, one with understanding should regard it as the nature of all the buddhas.

On
"Together with it, accomplishment
bestows the bliss of Mahāmudrā":
the meaning is that by meditating on the awakening mind endowed with such qualities according to the instructions, and relying on it constantly, one

becomes a perfect buddha. The rest is easy to understand.

"When the yoginī abides in the center of the body": she is yoga itself, and since she abides in the center of the body, it says "in the center of the body." In reality, the meaning is "in the center, nondual with method."

"Through the vow of a she perfectly abides": in the center of the maṇḍala of such a body, what is called "a" is the awakening mind. The vow is, conventionally, like kunā, white; and ultimately, since it constantly unites one with great bliss, it says "perfectly abides."

On
"As it is outwardly, so it is for oneself:
that vow is utterly clear,"
the meaning is that just as it appeared to other yogins in the past, so it becomes clear to oneself as well.

On
"The bliss of method is Mahāmudrā;
the vajra source is method":
the bliss of method is called Mahāmudrā because it arises from the bliss that arises from method itself. On "the vajra source is method": because it is born from the vajra, it is the vajra source; in reality this refers to the great Vajradhara himself. Moreover, because he holds a vajra, he is the Vajra Holder: this is the literal meaning. Because he holds the nature of the five gnoses, the mirror-like and the rest, he is the Vajra Holder: this is the general meaning. Because he holds a body whose nature is mind, he is the Vajra Holder: this is the hidden meaning. The vajra is nondual gnosis; because he holds it as his very essence, he is the Vajra Holder: this is the ultimate meaning. Such a Vajra Holder is what is meant by "the vajra source is method."

If one asks, "Since the awakening mind arises from one endowed with both method and wisdom, how could it arise from method alone?": however, since Mahāmudrā was mentioned above, and "the yoginī abiding in the center of the body" was mentioned, that mudrā refers to the wisdom mudrā. Therefore it says, "My method and wisdom are joined as a pair."

On "This secret": because this profound secret of method and wisdom is not the domain of dialecticians, it is secret. Or else: this very tantra teaches nothing but method and wisdom, and that is not the domain of non-Buddhists, śrāvakas, or people of inferior intellect; and it is taught that those who, lacking conviction, disparage it will remain in hell until the end of space. Therefore,

what need is there to mention bringing unexamined disciples who are not fit vessels into the maṇḍala, empowering them, and teaching them the instructions? Even uttering a few words to them, however few, or showing them the books, drawings, and the like, brings about a breach.

The great yoga tantra called the Highest Declaration also says:

"The secret mantra should be given to no one;
the instructions should not be corrupted.
To those who abide by the samaya, as befits them,
the instructions should be given."

Accordingly, the great yoga tantra called the glorious Guhyasamāja also says, "The secret of all the Tathāgatas." This very tantra also teaches:

"It is concealed in all the tantras,
and taught at the very last of the last."

So it is supremely secret.

If one asks, "Is there then nothing secret about offerings, maṇḍalas, and the like?": those are taught for the assembly of those with dull faculties, whereas this instruction of all the Tathāgatas, the secret of method, the complete purification of the three appearances, is taught to disciples of sharp faculties; therefore it is secret.

On "perfectly assembled": because two are assembled into one, it is an assembly: this is the literal meaning. It is the perfect union of vajra and lotus: this is the general meaning. The perfect union of wisdom and method is the assembly: this is the hidden meaning. It is the assembly of the conventional and ultimate truths; since that arises from luminosity, the great Vajradhara, whose nature is nondual gnosis, is the ultimate meaning. Because he does not conceive of duality, it says, "One should not imagine it outwardly as two."

Alternatively, on "One should not imagine it outwardly as two": the tatvasaṃgraha and other such texts teach method alone, whereas this arises from the nonduality of method and wisdom. Since it is free of the conception of two and has abandoned it, it says, "One should not imagine it as two."

On the passage that begins

The three bodies, in the very center of the body,
Are taught in the form of wheels,

it means that the three bodies abide in the center of the yogin's body: the Dharma body, the body of perfect enjoyment, and the emanation body. Moreover, since they are shown in the form of the wheel of emanation, the wheel of Dharma, the wheel of enjoyment, and the wheel of bliss, it says "in the form of wheels."

On

Dharma, enjoyment, emanation,
And likewise great bliss,

the meaning is that the Dharma body abides in the wheel at the heart, the body of perfect enjoyment abides in the lotus at the throat, the emanation body abides in the lotus at the navel, and great bliss abides in the lotus at the crown of the head.

On

In the regions of bhaga, heart, and throat,
The three bodies truly abide,

the bhaga is the wheel of emanation, which has sixty-four spokes. On those spokes one places the thirty-two great ka letters in forward order and in reverse order, and in the center one places the syllable a. At the heart is the wheel of Dharma, with eight spokes, on which eight couples in union are arranged, and in the center one places the syllable hūṃ. At the throat is the wheel of enjoyment, with sixteen spokes, on which the sixteen great a letters are arranged, and in the center one places the syllable oṃ. At the crown of the head is the wheel of great bliss, with thirty-two spokes, on which one places the thirty-two great ka letters, and in the center one places the syllable haṃ. Therefore the wheel of emanation in the bhaga is the emanation body, at the throat is the body of perfect enjoyment, and the two, the heart and the crown, are gathered into the Dharma body. That is the meaning of "In them the three bodies truly abide." The rest should be understood as appropriate.

On

Through the divisions of the concordant result and the others,
The Blessed One strives in wisdom,

this amounts to saying that in this way the result concordant with its cause and the others arise from wisdom, and that this gives rise to unsurpassed awakening.

Someone may ask, "If wisdom endowed with method is like that, why do all the women of the world wander in the three realms?" In answer it says, "They are impelled by the wind of karma." That is, driven by the wind of virtuous and nonvirtuous karma, they wander in the three realms; but when that very one is endowed with method and obtains the oral instructions, awakening too is accomplished. As it is said:

For one endowed with great methods,
The afflictions are causes, limbs of awakening;
Saṃsāra too has the character of peace;
Therefore the tathāgatas are inconceivable.

Alternatively, "The Blessed One makes supplication to wisdom" means this: since wisdom is born and arises from the four results given above, it says "makes supplication to it." And "Action is impelled by wind" means this: the moon's melting and descending to the pericarp is itself the action of wind, and so through it are performed the actions of abiding stably and the like, as well as the actions of the wheels.

On "The belly is taught to be the celestial palace": the belly is the very cavity of the body. Because it abides in thought at the moment free of attachment, it is called "bhaga."

On "The outer robes are the blazing womb": in the world, those honored as venerable are the ones who have gone forth; but here it refers to generating the perception that all sentient beings have gone forth and are the Teacher. As the venerable Mahālakṣmī says:

One who knows mantra
Should hold no thing in contempt;
As the very self, Vajrasattva
Always dwells in a directly perceptible body.

And the noble Kāśyapa too said, "One regards all sentient beings with the perception that they are the Teacher." Therefore, entering the mother's womb and dwelling there, naturally wrapped in the afterbirth, is the outer robe. Just as the training arises in dependence on the preceptor, so the child grows through the afterbirth in dependence on the mother; therefore she is the preceptor.

On "Prostration is joining the palms to the protector": because at birth the child comes forth with its palms placed together at the forehead, it is called

"prostration." Then "gradually grown" means that the body develops gradually, just as through training one brings about the higher realms and awakening.

On "The mantra recitation is ud, the self": the child, born and come forth from the womb, remains naked, and this is the guise of a naked ascetic. After that, the shaving of its head is the monk.

"Beings such as these" means there is no doubt that they are buddhas. Moreover, the venerable Indrabhūti too has said:

Pervading the minds of all beings,
Vajrasattva himself abides.

Since he has said this, just as, for example, if one finds a single ounce of gold-making elixir and smears it on a thousand ounces of iron, all of it is certain to turn into gold, so generating the certainty that all sentient beings are buddhas is what is called "there is no doubt." Therefore the point is that the yogin who has entered the door of this tantra also meditates on all sentient beings and all things as having the intrinsic nature of glorious Heruka. The rest is easy to understand, and so I have not written it out.

On

These sentient beings are buddhas,
Yet they are pervaded by the stains of the imputed nature;
When those are removed, they are buddhas,

the meaning is that all sentient beings have the nature of all the buddhas: they are the essence of awakening, whose nature is the Dharma body. If one wonders, "Then why do they wander in the three realms?" it says, "Yet they are pervaded by the stains of the imputed nature." That is, infused with the imprints of ignorance, and having engaged in various actions under the power of the latent afflictions, they are born in the abodes of the three realms and wander there. If one asks, "Is there then no method to purify them?" it says, "When those are removed, they are buddhas." Distinguishing the Middle from the Extremes also says:

This is both stained and stainless;
Like the water element, gold, and space,
It is held to be pure just as they are pure.

And the Tantra Requested by Subāhu also says:

Being stained by the afflictions, attachment and the rest,
This mind is therefore said to be saṃsāra;
When, its afflictions purified, it is like crystal and the moon,
It is proclaimed the end of the ocean of existence.

So the meaning is that when the afflictions are completely purified, all are buddhas, without doubt.

On "One's own mind itself is awakening": the very mind of all sentient beings is buddha, and no buddha other than the mind is to be found apart from it. The Chapter on Transcending the World also says: "Children of the Victor, the three realms are mind only. Understanding the three times too as mind only, understand that this mind too is without extreme or middle."

The master, the venerable Nāgārjuna, also said:

The mind by which the childish
Are bound with the bonds of saṃsāra:
Through that very mind the yogin
Will go to the abode of the sugatas.

And the All-Secret Tantra also says:

The fivefold nature of the five elements,
The human body, is made firm;
By meditating with certainty on that very thing,
One becomes a buddha through the power of one's own mind.

And this tantra itself also says:

Nowhere in the world systems
Will a buddha be found;
The mind itself is the perfect buddha,
And no buddha has been taught elsewhere.

Since this is what they say, that is the meaning of "There is no buddha apart from the mind." The rest is easy to understand.

On the passage that begins

Earth is known as Pukkasī,
Just as she is the seal of Akṣobhya;
And whatever delusion and earths there are,
The body is taught to be Vairocana,

as to the pairing with the body and with Vairocana, and likewise the pairing with Akṣobhya, and so on: body and mind arise in dependence on each other, and neither arises by itself. In the same way, the Tathāgata family and the five families also depend on one another; and since they arise in the manner of cause and effect, the Vajra family is paired with the family of delusion, and the elements too arise interchanged with one another.

On "In the center of the wheel are the three secrets," the meaning is that they abide in the center of the wheel of the body.

On "Bhūcarī is the seal of the body," she who moves on the earth is the Mahāmudrā of the body; this is what is meant by "The one with the vajra body gazes downward," and it is paired with the father. "Khecarī is the seal of desire" is paired with the mother, and of it is said, "The Vajrā goddesses gaze upward."

On "The mind has the form of Nairātmyā," this refers to the awakening mind, which is empty through the twofold selflessness, completely purified of the stains of apprehended and apprehender, and free of all extremes. That is the meaning of "abiding in the center."

On "It is divided into six families," the six families are Akṣobhya, Vairocana, Ratnasambhava, Amitābha, Amoghasiddhi, and Vajrasattva: these are the six. The rest is easy to understand. This is the explanation of the fourth chapter.

Now I shall explain the fifth chapter. Because this tantra in general teaches only the oral instructions and is not the domain of the śrāvakas and the like, it speaks with hidden intent and teaches in code, and it must be learned from the mouth of the guru; therefore its terms are not explained in detail.

On

He kisses Nairātmyā;
The Lord touches the skull cup,

this refers to Hevajra himself, nondual with the consort. Vajra Skull Cup is Heruka. "And also grasps the stana" means grasping the breasts. The meaning is that he then makes the maṇḍala of union clear. The rest is easy to understand.

On "Delighting, the pairs are joined in equality," the meaning is that from the nonduality of father and mother they possess the ultimate joy.

On

Through the unmoving's own form,
The bliss of the unmoving is attained,

the meaning is this: at the time of culmination, since by its very nature it does not stray toward any thought at all, it is called "through its own form." Since it does not stray anywhere at all, and at that moment one attains the accomplishment of Mahāmudrā, it amounts to saying "bliss is attained."

"The rest are black like bees" carries the meaning of "The right face is white, the left red, and the central one black; the rest are black like the tail of a bee." The rest is easy to understand and so has not been written out.

As for Heruka's hand emblems, his holding the skull cups of the eight, the elephant and the rest, is a sign that he brings the wealth of the great gods under his power. His holding the eight, earth, water, and the rest, refers to their gods. "The two-drinker and the rest, in order": the two-drinker is the elephant. This gives the explanation of the elephant, the horse, and so on mentioned above. The elephant first sucks up water and the like with its trunk, and only then lifts it with its trunk up into its mouth; since it drinks in two stages, it is called the two-drinker (dvipa). The meaning is that he holds the skull cups of such creatures and the rest. As for earth, water, and the rest: earth is the lord of the earth; water is Varuṇa, god of the waters; wind is Vāyu, god of the wind; fire is Agni, god of fire; and likewise the sun and the moon; Antaka, the Ender, that is, Yama; and the Wealth Guardian, that is, Kubera. The meaning is that he holds their skull cups. If one asks why, it amounts to this: since all beings, the gods and the rest as well as the elephant and the rest, possess the cause of awakening, he holds them as hand emblems in order to draw them in. The rest is easy to understand and so has not been written out.

"Ḍombī is of various colors" means that she has the nature of the five colors: white at the head, yellow below it, and so on. The rest is easy to understand.

"And having summoned Tilottamā": she is one of the court ladies of Śakra (Indra). The meaning is that he summoned her, blessed her, and empowered Vajragarbha.

On "With a long sound, faultlessly and well," this refers to drawing out the sound hūṃ long. On "One summons the yoṣits," it means summoning women with that mantra.

On

The very beginning of the Vedas
Is adorned with a half moon,

the beginning of the Vedas refers to the syllable oṃ, and the half moon is marked above it with a bindu. The words beginning aṣṭānanā are the mantra of the eight-faced Heruka.

On

In the west, a tortoise,
And in the north draw a snake as well,

this is mistaken and should be examined. Above, among the hand emblems of the two deities, the snake is held in the west and the tortoise in the north; if so, this seems not to agree with how the emblems are drawn, so examine it carefully! The rest are great points of oral instruction, to be learned from the mouth of the guru. This is the explanation of the fifth chapter.

Now I shall explain the sixth chapter of the second part. On

The goddess embraces tightly,
And wisdom touches method,

touching is placing the vajra in the lotus. "The steadfast one, grasping the hair" means grasping the goddess's beautiful body. Because the nails of wisdom are pressed into the whole body, it is called sporting with the nails. Then, becoming nondual is union. This is the explanation of the sixth chapter.

Now, from the seventh chapter, the explanation concerning the book is given. On "Having made ink of the great bee," the meaning is that one writes the letters with a pen of human bone, using an ink of soot from human fat, grease, and the like. "Wicked people" refers to those who have no sacred commitments. If they see the image and the book, the meaning is that one is cut off from accomplishments in this life and in all one's lives. "Hide it from the unruly and the common" means hiding it in the armpit or in the hair. On "The book, when traveling the road," the meaning is that even if one finds no other place to hide one's book, one should hide it beneath one's undergarment and the cloth that covers the three circles.

On "Those with the forms of the nine dead," it amounts to saying that they are seated on nine corpse seats. The vyāghra skin is a tiger skin.

On "And the foods are eaten again," the meaning is that at the time of the gaṇacakra one enjoys food, drink, and the like again and again.

On "Then one makes offerings to the mātṛkās," the meaning is that, having in this way offered the enjoyments of food, drink, and the like to the deities of the maṇḍala of the yogin's body, one then presents a torma offering from the remainder of that rite to the mātṛkās, the ḍākinīs, and the rest. Alternatively, the meaning of "One should make offerings to the mātṛkās" is this: after making offerings in this way with food, drink, and the like, and with dance, song, and the like, one makes offering with the offering of the unsurpassed bliss of union. The rest is easy to understand. This is the explanation of the seventh chapter.

Now I shall explain the meaning of the eighth chapter. On "Then the yoginī asked," the meaning is that the goddess Nairātmyā asked. On "What is the Mahāmudrā like?", this refers to the consort, who is called the Mahāmudrā; her marks and signs are made clear in the tantra itself, and so they are not written out here.

Then the goddess, delighted,
Addressed him in these words:
"The lowest beings, hard to tame,
How are they to be tamed?"
The Blessed One said:
"First, set them in the restoration observance (poṣadha);
After that, give them the ten precepts too;
Then teach them the Vaibhāṣika as well;
And then again the Sautrāntika;
Then the Practice should also be taught;
After that, the two Madhyamakas should be taught;
All the tantras should be known;
Then set them in Hevajra.
When the disciple has taken it up with respect,
There is no doubt that he will succeed."

Someone may ask: "Since the tantra itself says, 'When there is the completion stage, what use is the generation stage?', what is wrong with training in Hevajra itself, without needing to abide in the stages of training?" But this objection of yours is like amassing wealth for a son while having no wife. Hence the great tantra Compendium of Reality (Tattvasaṃgraha) also says that all the tathāgatas said to the bodhisattva Sarvārthasiddhi: "Since that mind is luminous by nature, it is like the moon. The disc of the moon becomes full gradually; likewise, that mind which is luminous by nature also becomes

complete gradually." Moreover, the sūtras say: "In the world, archery and the crafts, and fruit, grain, and the like, come to completion gradually, not all at once." In the same way, one who trains in the samādhi of the completion stage should also train by gradual entry, not all at once. Therefore, without isolation of body, one cannot know isolation of speech. Lacking isolation of speech, one cannot realize isolation of mind. Without the samādhi in which the nature of mind is free of appearance, one cannot make the conventional truth directly manifest. Lacking realization of the conventional truth, one cannot make the ultimate truth directly manifest. Without the ultimate truth, one cannot make the stage of union directly manifest. Seeing this reason, the Blessed One too declared: "One should train by gradual entry, not all at once. By training in the completion stage through gradual entry, one's own mindstream becomes completely purified all at once." Here it is said:

For beings who are beginners
To enter the ultimate,
The perfect buddhas have set out the method
Like the rungs of a ladder.

Enough elaboration; let us turn to the main text itself. It should be understood as the answer to "The lowest beings, hard to tame, how are they to be tamed?" Therefore, having childish ordinary people, who are like cattle, go for refuge to the Three Jewels and keep the eight-limbed precepts is called "First, set them in the restoration observance." In order for them to face nirvāṇa even more directly than that, having them keep the ten precepts of a novice is called "Then give them the ten precepts too." After that comes the Vaibhāṣika, that is, teaching the Dharma of the śrāvaka Vaibhāṣikas; then the Sautrāntika, that is, one teaches the Dharma of the śrāvaka Sautrāntikas and confers on them the two hundred and fifty precepts of a fully ordained monk. Then the Practice is taught: one has them generate the conventional mind of awakening and teaches them the doctrines of the Yogācāra. After that, one teaches the meaning of the great Madhyamaka, free of all extremes, and has them generate the ultimate mind of supreme awakening. Then, guarding against the forty-two transgressions of a bodhisattva and the eight defeats, they should enter and practice by way of the perfections. Then, further, in order to attain complete and perfect buddhahood swiftly, they enter the door of liberation of the secret mantra: from holy gurus they enter the maṇḍala, receive empowerment, and obtain the sacred commitments, and they come to know all the outer and inner tantras. That is the meaning of "All the tantras should

be known." Then, at last, they enter the door of the hero Hevajra and receive the empowerment of wisdom and gnosis; and by engaging in practice they will without doubt attain the accomplishment of Mahāmudrā. That, therefore, is the meaning of:

Then set them in Hevajra.
When the disciple has taken it up with respect,
There is no doubt that he will succeed.

This is the explanation of the eighth chapter of the second part.

Now I shall explain the meaning of the ninth chapter. It concerns performing the fierce rite against those who have become enemies of the Three Jewels and the guru. On "The characteristic of what comes forth from the joining," "comes forth from" refers to drawing the mind out of the enemy's aggregates.

"From the root of the target's navel" means this: with a hook (aṅkuśa) one draws the mind out of the enemy's navel and gathers the three syllables at the heart; when they are drawn outside, he dies. The meaning is that by performing such an application many times, even a buddha would perish. Further, it amounts to saying that the syllable nṛ abides in the enemy's heart, and if one seizes it with the iron hook as before, it succeeds. Moreover, this should be embraced by great compassion at the beginning, in the middle, and at the end. One who lacks compassion will himself perish as well.

On "Then, imagining needles in the pathways," one imagines needles driven into that enemy's heart and into all his pores; and if one also imagines his heart and the rest being burned by fire, he will die.

"Look, O precious goddess!" means this: a jewel whose eye has not been pierced is of little value, while one that is pierced is of great value. Likewise, to find the nonconceptual samādhi that purifies existence is called "precious," and conceiving of things as real is not like that. If one performs the practice of accomplishment with such a blazing body, that is the meaning of "One attains accomplishment just as one wishes." This is like a precious maṇḍala, and so the meaning is that it is endowed with all desirable qualities. The rest is easy to understand and so has not been written out.

On

I shall explain the secret mantras:
The first is Vairocana,

this teaches the extraction of the mantras of the second chapter. Why? They are taught in hidden form so that those without sacred commitments, and deceitful people such as the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas), will not understand them.

Someone may object: "If the Tathāgata keeps nothing hidden from sentient beings and has all-pervading compassion, then concealing the letters and so forth here is a contradiction." Although the Tathāgata has no withholding and makes no distinctions, beings who have not become vessels cannot enter into the meaning; their minds are trained gradually in the distinctions of the vehicles, and only when at some point they have become vessels for it is it taught to them. Therefore the Tathāgata remains from eon to eon even for the sake of each single being, and he establishes beings in awakening gradually; for he does not establish them all at once, in a single instant, as a creator would. However, to those who are fit vessels and possess the highest faculties the secret vehicle is taught, while to those who are not, the other stages of the vehicles are taught; and it is kept secret from those who have not been empowered and do not abide by the sacred commitments.

The commentary on the Perfection of Wisdom in a Hundred and Fifty Modes also says: "As to the extent of the secrecy toward those who have not entered the sacred commitment, it was declared, 'Even to the bodhisattva Maitreya it does not appear as light.' Maitreya requested: 'I am a bodhisattva bound to one more birth, and all the tathāgatas have prophesied that I will attain manifest awakening in a later time. Since this is so, I see all the buddha fields of the ten directions and the inconceivable qualities of the body, speech, and mind of all the tathāgatas; I am only just veiled from buddhahood. Nothing whatsoever is secret from me, so why should this maṇḍala you have made be secret from me?' He declared: 'Maitreya, although you see everything, you have not previously entered the sacred commitment of this maṇḍala, and it is not permitted to show it to one who has not entered.' Later the bodhisattva Maitreya entered this very maṇḍala and, overjoyed, praised it."

And this very tantra also says:

Whoever, without the empowerment of Hevajra,
Speaks the words of hidden intent
Will come to break the sacred commitment;
Of this there is no doubt.
Through seizing spirits, bandits, and thieves,

Through fevers, spirits, and poisons,
Even were he a buddha, he would die.

Therefore, since the meaning of the mantras is taught in hidden form, there is no contradiction.

"The first is Vairocana" is oṃ. "To the fourth of the sibilants" is hā. The line "Beautified by Pukkasī, pressed by emptiness" is u, and "pressed by emptiness" is the bindu. From the combination of these three, hūṃ is formed. With svāhā at its end, it is the mantra of subjugation.

"At the beginning, the first group" is a. "Then likewise Khecarī" is u. On "At the end one should join svāhā": emptiness is the bindu, and svāhā is meant literally. This is the mantra for causing enmity; explicitly, it is vajri svāhā.

"The lord of the first group" is a. "And the third of the fifth" is ba. On "Joining emptiness and Ḍākinī as well," emptiness is the bindu, and Ḍākinī is u. "With svāhā at the end, one performs the fierce rite": explicitly, it is oṃ buṃ svāhā.

"In the very first group" is e. "hūṃ together with the red one, and together with svāhā at the end": explicitly, this is oṃ hū svāhā, the mantra of summoning.

"To the first, of the family of delusion" is o. On

Join ghu as well, correctly;
And joining svāhā at the end
Will kill gods and humans,

explicitly, it is oṃ ghu svāhā.

"At the start, the first" is oṃ. "Join Vajraḍākinī correctly" is u. "First, to Vairocana himself" is a. "To the second of the semivowels" is ra. "Join with Vajraḍākinī" is u. "To the first of the first" is ka. "Join correctly with Ḍākinī" is u. "Again, to the first of the first, join correctly with Ḍākinī" is the two, ka and u. "The third of the semivowels" is la. "Join another likewise, correctly, adorned above by Caurī" is e. On

Join hi as well, correctly;
At the end let it have svāhā:
This is the secret mantra of Kurukullā,

the meaning is that explicitly it is Kurukullā's dhi.

On "First oṃ, then the third of the fourth": oṃ is meant literally, and the third of the fourth is da. "Adorned by Caurī" is e. "To the fourth of the semivowels" is lba. It is joined with deb picu vajra. "To the fourth of the sibilants" means joining ha and a. "Adorned by Pukkasī" is u. "Pressed by emptiness and tripled" is hūṃ three times. "The third of the fifth" is pa. "To the first of the third" is ṭa.

On

With svāhā at the end,
It is the heart of Hevajra,

explicitly, deva picu vajra hūṃ hūṃ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā is said to be the heart of Hevajra.

"First, to Vairocana" is a. "jvala jvala, set out distinctly," is literal. "The fourth of the fifth" is bha. "Join the first of the semivowels" is ya. "Adorned by Ghasmarī" is o. "From the fourth of the sibilants" is hā. "Correctly adorned by Vajraḍākinī" is a. "Pressed by emptiness and tripled" is hūṃ three times. "The second of the fifth" is pha. "The first of the third" is ṭa. "Together with the ending svāhā" is literal. That is the mantra of the four-armed one.

"The first is Vairocana" is a. "The first of the first" is kā. "The first of the third" is ṭa. "Join them in the inner order" is i, that is, the vowel sign gigu. "It is to be doubled" is literal. "The third of the fifth" is ba. "The third of the second" is ja. "Adorned by fire" is ra. "Join with three hūṃ" is literal. "And the second of the fifth" is pha. "And the first of the third" is ṭa. "At the end, put svāhā": this is the mantra of the six-armed one.

"The first is Vairocana" is a. The first of the fourth is ta. "Adorned also by fire" is ra. "Adorned by Vetālī" is e. The third of the semivowels is la. "Adorned by Ghasmarī" is o. "To the first of the first" is ka. "Joined correctly also with Vajrā" is a. In "kṣa, adorned by Caurī," kṣa is literal, and Caurī is e. "And the first of the fifth" is ba. "The fourth of the sibilants" is ha. "Adorned by Vajraḍākinī" is a. "Pressed by emptiness and tripled" is hūṃ three times. "Together with phaṭ and svāhā at the end" is literal. This is the mantra of the two-armed one.

Nairātmyā: the first of the first is ka. The first of the second is ca. The first of the third is ṭa. The first of the fourth is ta. The first of the fifth is pa. The first of the semivowels is ya. The first of the sibilants is śa. "The first is Vairocana" is a. "With svāhā at the end": this is the mantra for throwing a country into turmoil, and it is recited a hundred thousand times.

The second of the semivowels is rā. kṣa, the second, and hūṃ, the third, are literal. "The first is Vairocana" is a. "Placed at the end, joined with svāhā" means that svāhā is joined at the foot. This is the mantra for purifying the substances.

"The first is Vairocana" is oṃ. "With Vajrā, having āḥ and hūṃ" is the mantra for blessing drink and the like.

"The first is Vairocana" is oṃ. "With Vajrā, akāro mukho": that is just as in the mantra above. The third of the sibilants is sa. The fourth of the semivowels is lba. "Adorned above by fire" is ra. dharmāṇāṃ, which follows, is literal. "Vajrā too" is a. ādyanutpannatvāt and oṃ āḥ hūṃ phaṭ svāhā: this is the torma rite for all the hosts of bhūta spirits.

This is the explanation of the chapter of the second part on extracting the mantras, the explanation of the ninth chapter.

Next comes the explanation of the tenth chapter of the second part. This chapter teaches mantra recitation; which rites are to be performed with which kinds of rosary; how, when it is smeared with the appropriate substances, it is made into a jewel full of splendor; and further, what is to be done with the śva of the last; and the "sa pa" is connected with what was explained above. This is the explanation of the chapter on recitation of the second part, that is, the explanation of the tenth chapter.

Now I shall give the explanation of the eleventh chapter of the second part. This chapter teaches the bodily marks of the yoginīs, the lines of their hands, and the signs of their coloring; since it is easy to understand, I have not written it out.

Translator's Notes

• Evident scribal slips are translated as intended: za ba mo as zab mo (the profound), 'dzag me as 'jog mi (cannot settle), chag nyes as cha gnyis (both aspects), tha dang pa as tha dad pa (distinct), me dga' as mi dga' (taking no delight), 'do srungs as 'od srung (Kāśyapa), dang ba'i yul as dang dga' ba'i yul (pleasing objects), and skyur as sgyur in dbang sgyur (Vaśavartin) and 'khor los sgyur ba (wheel-turning monarch). In the sentence on Kāśyapa the Tibetan says literally that he "spoke and did not teach"; a negative may have dropped out, since the parallel sentences say the other buddhas did not declare these teachings. Several tantra titles could not be identified with confidence and are rendered by meaning: rab tu grub pa'i rgyud (perhaps the Susiddhi), rtogs pa thams cad bsdus pa'i rgyud (perhaps the Sarvakalpasamuccaya, if rtogs is read rtog), 'dul ba don yod par grub pa, nges par brjod pa bla ma (perhaps the Abhidhānottara), and rdo rje dra ba'i rgyud.
• "lnga brgya tham" is read as lnga brgya tha ma, "the last five hundred years," the final period

of the teaching. Evident scribal slips are translated as intended: 'dun as bdun (seven lifetimes), skyur as sgyur (wheel-turning), ces as ci (whatever forms), len as yin, gyes as gyis, dpog as phog (conferred), rgyu dang po as rgyud dang po (first tantra, twice), and ming shigs as mi shigs (indestructible); byin du is taken as bindu. The sentence "gzu lu mas ma yin pa'i phyir ro" is obscure; it is read with gzu lum, "partiality," and its force is uncertain. The commentator's name rdo rje tse npra could not be identified and is given as spelled. The "five-faced one with five crest-locks" (gdong lnga gtsug phud lnga pa) is an unidentified non-Buddhist teacher, perhaps a form of Śiva; zur phud lnga pa is taken as Pañcaśikha. The tantra title "thun mong ma yin pa gsang ba" could not be identified and is rendered by meaning. In the exegesis of "thus by me," the Sanskrit syllables are matched with the four words of the Tibetan phrase 'di skad bdag gis, rendered here as "this," "manner," "me," and "by."

• The Tibetan word for the Blessed One, bcom ldan 'das, is glossed by its parts: "endowed" (ldan) with the six qualities, and "destroyer" (bcom) of the māras. In the root line "Great compassion is the joyous He," the Tibetan dgyes pa, "joy," renders the syllable He of the name Hevajra; "joyous essence" likewise renders snying po dgyes. Evident slips are read as intended: rtog tu as rtag tu ("ever"), rgyu dang yes bshad as rgyud nga yis bshad ("I shall explain the tantra"), srub as sgrub ("accomplishes"), and ta ta saṃ gra ha as the Tattvasaṃgraha. The phrase la la dag ni ("some") that opens the last paragraph may be a slip for la la nā ni ("Lalanā"), which would make it a citation of the root line "Lalanā has the nature of wisdom."

• The thirty-two channel names are given in their Sanskrit forms, identified by their order in the Hevajra's own list, since several Tibetan spellings here are corrupt. This enumeration omits Surūpiṇī and includes two forms not in that list, Udrinidarni (where Ūṣmā stands in the root list) and Kataya; these are given as spelled and could not be identified. Evident slips are read as intended: rgyud as rgyu (carries), bshad as bshang (excrement), skra as sgra (sound; the sentence on Kāminī is written twice and translated once), rig bya as reg bya (tangible objects), rtogs pa as rtog pa (conceptual thought), ste as sde (school), las as 'bar (blazing) in the root verse on Caṇḍālī, mi nyid as me nyid (fire), and lum as yum (mothers). Rna sbabs is taken, tentatively, as earwax. "The moon" in the root verse renders the Sanskrit word śaśin, written in Tibetan letters. The sentence comparing this bliss to the untouchable caṇḍālī contains Sanskrit syllables whose sense is obscure; it is translated literally.

• Evident slips are read as intended: kye as kyi, bra ba as bral ba, zhi as ni, skyi bo as spyi bo, and 'phral ba as dpral ba, "forehead." Gar is taken in its sense "where," and mtshog ma as the forehead. The Sanskrit words kaloka and kar in the gloss on the flowing of the moon are obscure and are given as written. The objection speaks of "thirty" marks, presumably meaning the thirty-two; it is translated as written. Nor skyong, "Guardian of Wealth," is taken as Kubera, the god whose skull cup Hevajra holds among those in his left hands.

• The opening lemma, zhi ga kha dag ba can, which the commentary glosses as an earthen bowl, could not be identified and is given in phonetics. In the tilaka recipe, li ordinarily means bell metal, though it may stand for li khri, red lead, the usual tilaka pigment; brtags pa is read as btags pa, "ground." Rigs drug here means the six buddha families, not the six classes of beings, so the glossary rendering was not used. The second gloss on the vajra mudrā is terse; its last clause (yum gyi phyag rgya la zhes bya'o) is taken to explain the word "with" in the lemma as union with the consort's mudrā.

• The goddess at the center of the maṇḍala is written in a garbled form (ra ātma); it is read as Nairātmyā, the central goddess of this fifteen-goddess maṇḍala, as the fifteen seats confirm. Evident slips are read as follows: mtshan gyis bsad pa as mtshon gyis, "slain by weapons," matching the root line; dad chub as dad chung, "little appetite"; mtshams bzhin as mtshams bzhi na, "in the four intermediate directions."

In two quoted root lines some syllables yield no clear sense (mri in the line on the banner; byis and ta in the line on eating flesh); these lines are rendered as the commentary explains them.

"Vajra Skull Cup" translates rdo rje thod pa, which the commentary gives as a name for the practitioner; a Sanskrit form could not be confirmed.
"The lower mudrā" and "the higher modes of deportment" are rendered literally; they may instead mean the mudrā described below and the deportment described above. "The Mother" may refer either to the consort or to the Perfection of Wisdom.
• "Seven-seven" evidently renders Sanskrit saptasapti, "having seven horses," an epithet of the sun; this underlies the first reading, while the second counts seven and seven as the fourteen goddesses.
"Thorough attachment" renders rnam par chags pa, which appears to calque Sanskrit virāga, ordinarily "dispassion"; hence its equation with nirvāṇa.
"Through the continuity of means" renders thabs rgyud in the root line; the commentary glosses the line as serving the guru at all times.
• Two cited titles could not be identified with confidence and are translated by meaning: "the Unfailing Accomplishment of Discipline" ('dul ba don yod par grub pa) and "the Highest Declaration" (nges par brjod pa bla ma), which may be the Abhidhānottara.
Evident slips are read as follows: ri su la as ri sul, "mountain ravines"; dogs as ngogs, "banks"; dud khrod as dur khrod, "charnel ground"; man bag as man ngag, "pith instructions." The unclear rong ru in the sentence on the mantra practitioner's maṇḍala is taken loosely as "in terms of."
• The syllables bhu, su, and ku give the traditional etymology of the name Bhusuku: eating (bhuñjāna), sleeping (supta), and going to the hut (kuṭī).
Evident slips are read as follows: skyid bar byed as skye bar byed, "is produced," matching the root line; shashi nu ba as zhu ba, "the melting moon," in line with the melted moon as the conventional awakening mind above; thob ma med pa as thog ma med pa, "beginningless"; bshar sa as bshang sa, "latrine."
The word rendered "friction" (rog pa) is unclear as written; the reading follows the commentary's gloss on the heat of fire. "Images" renders the unclear sku dang 'dris, read as sku 'dra.
• The word rendered "forehead" is spelled 'phral ba in both root and commentary; it is read as dpral ba, as the commentary's "looking upward" indicates.
In the passage on meat obtained by killing, the words "various accomplishments arise" appear to be repeated from the sentence above; they are rendered as the killer's motive.
Evident slips are read as follows: gsogs as bsogs, "gathered"; sma as smra, "say"; lhag pa as lhag ma, "the rest."
"The way into it is clear" renders the uncertain sgo bsal bas. "Nairātmyā" in the root lines could also be read as "selflessness." The commentary states that looking to the right also brings the target under one's power, although the right gaze is usually the gaze of summoning; this is translated as it stands.
• Readings adopted for evident copyist slips: rnal 'byor pa ("the yogins") for 'byor pa; zad ("exhausted") for zang, though bzang ("[realization] is excellent") is also possible; byang or sbyang ("purified, trained") for blang; bden for bde in the Blessed One's reply ("what you say is true and yet not true"); mchog tu dga' ba ("supreme joy") for mchod tu dga' ba.
The word sgre'u, which "the other" part of the goddess's form becomes, is taken as "the testicles," matching the root's "bells on the two sides"; the term is uncertain.
"The joy that has left the third behind" renders gsum pa spangs pa'i dga' ba, apparently the fourth, innate joy beyond the third; it might instead mean "the third, the joy of cessation."
"With their tenfold distinctions" renders bcu'i khyad par as it stands; the text does not say which ten are meant.
mkha' 'gro sgyu ma bde mchog is taken as the title Ḍākinījālasaṃvara (the

Sarvabuddhasamāyoga), whose Tibetan title uses this wording.
• Readings adopted for evident copyist slips: skye ("would be reborn as gods") for skyo; gang gis ("by what then does one go to hell?") for rang gis in Śuka's verse, which is also how the well-known Sanskrit form of this verse ends; ji ltar bgrang ("how could they count") for ltar bgrang, read as a rhetorical question; bram ze for gram ze; yang for lang.
byin du is a transcription of Sanskrit bindu.
rnam pa'i, qualifying "the vow" in the first gloss ("the vow in its aspects"), is obscure and may be a slip.
dpal gyi sde is given as Śrīsena, the regular Sanskrit equivalent; I could not identify this Guhyasamāja commentator with certainty.
The commentaries reread the command to kill through the double sense of srog, "life" and the vital wind (prāṇa): taking life becomes stopping the breath-wind in signless absorption and destroying the view of self through emptiness.
• Readings adopted for evident copyist slips: bsgral ba for bsgral la; sgrol ba zhes for sgrol bzhes; spros pas chog go ("enough elaboration") for spros pas cho ga gi; gzung ba for gzug ba; ri mo'i gos ("a garment of various patterns") for ri bo'i gos ("mountain"), as the commentary's gloss "many-colored" requires; ro la for rol; bas ma bris for bsam bris.
dang pa is taken as dang ba, "clear."
In the list of code words, thab chu ("hearth water") glossed as dro ("warmth") and chu ("water") glossed as bu rogs ("companion") are obscure; both are rendered literally.
bdag med and rdo rje in the root lines on aversion and delusion are taken as the goddesses Nairātmyā and Vajrā, the mudrās of the families of Akṣobhya and Vairocana; they could also be read as "selfless" and "vajra."
• Readings adopted for evident copyist slips: phyag rgya ("the mudrā of avarice") for phyag na; zhen for zhe na; rmongs dang for rmongs dad; dug med for dug mer; 'od srungs (Kāśyapa) for 'ong srungs; khro la khro ba ("wrathful to the wrathful") for khrol khro ba; de dag gi ("their arrogance") for rtogs pa dang gi.
The phrase ma dang mar 'dzin pa is obscure; it is conjecturally read as mtshan mar 'dzin pa, "grasping at signs."
In the Vajrajāla verse, mi yis ("by a man") is taken as a slip for "by that very [desire]," the familiar tantric point that desire is overcome by desire.
dam tshig chen po'i rgyud could not be identified with confidence and is rendered "the Great Samaya Tantra."
• Readings adopted for evident copyist slips: lta bu ("like") for lha in the gloss on the moon of the fifteenth day; 'od gsal ("luminosity") for 'do gsal; dus su ("in the past") for dus sam; chung ngu nas ("however few") for chung ngun.
ma mos te, in the passage on disparaging the tantra, is the negated verb "lacking conviction," not the name Mātṛkā.
The four glosses on Vajradhara and on "assembled" follow the four modes of explanation: literal, general, hidden, and ultimate.
• Evident readings adopted: in the root line first quoted as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□, the reading □□□□□□□□□□□□□□, "when those are removed," which the commentary itself gives a little later; in the root line on the three bodies, □□□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□□□, "in the regions of"; in the verse on great methods, □□□□□□ as □□□□□, "peace"; □□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□, "imprints"; □□□□□□□ as □□□□□□, "spokes"; and □□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□, "forehead." The root passage maps birth onto monastic ordination: the afterbirth as the robe, the mother as the preceptor, the joined palms as prostration, growth as training, the naked newborn as the naked ascetic, and the shaven head as the monk. Two of its lines are obscure as transmitted here: "the blazing womb" (□□□□□□□□□□), which the commentary explains as the afterbirth wrapping the child, and the line on mantra recitation (□□□□□□□□), where □□□ is kept as a syllable and □□□ is rendered "the self"; the

commentary passes from that line straight to the naked ascetic. □□□□□ is taken as Sanskrit karṇikā, the pericarp of the lotus. The great ka and great a letters are the consonant and vowel series of the alphabet.

• Readings adopted: □□□□ as □□□□, Sanskrit stana, "breast," one of the Sanskrit words the Tibetan root keeps untranslated and the commentary glosses (□□□□□, Sanskrit yoṣit, "woman," is another); □□□□□□ as □□□□□□, "elephant"; □□□□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□□□, "below it"; and □□□□□□□□□ as bindu. The two-drinker is Sanskrit dvipa, a name for the elephant, which the commentator explains by its etymology. Here □□□□□□□□□ is the six buddha families the commentary lists, not the six classes of beings, and □□□□□ is the color yellow. The name Nairātmyā means selflessness, which is why the commentary explains the line through the twofold selflessness. □□□□□□□□□□□□□ in the heading of the sixth chapter is taken as the second part of the tantra rather than its title. □□□□□□□□□ is translated by meaning, "the Wealth Guardian," since the text itself identifies it as Kubera.

• Readings adopted: □□□□□□□ as □□□□□□, "cut off"; the root line □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, "hide it from the unruly and the common"; □□ as □□, "dance"; □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, "enough elaboration"; □□□□□□ as □□□□□□□, Sautrāntika; and □□□□ as □□□□, "confer." □□□□□□□□, literally "great bee," is left literal as a code term; the commentary explains the ink as soot from human fat. □□□□□ is taken as an undergarment; the three circles are the navel and the two knees, which the lower robe must cover. □□□□□ is taken as a loanword for a novice (compare Sanskrit cela, "disciple"). The root verse reads "the two Madhyamakas" (□□□□□□□□□□), kept as written, though the commentary explains a single great Madhyamaka; "the Practice" (□□□□□□□) is the root's short name for the Yogācāra. The root line on "the joining" (□□□□□□) that opens the ninth chapter is obscure; it may refer to two vessels joined mouth to mouth, as in fierce rites.

• Readings adopted: □□□□□□□□□□□ as □□□□□□□□□□□, "those without sacred commitments"; □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ as □□□, "the lord of the first group"; and a phrase repeated by dittography after the Pukkasī line is rendered once. In Maitreya's words the clause □□ is corrupt and is rendered by its evident sense, "I am only just veiled from buddhahood"; □□□□□□□□□, rendered "withholding," is uncertain. The "eye" of a jewel is the hole drilled to string it. The mantra passage decodes, letter by letter, the mantras taught openly in the tantra's mantra chapter: "the first group" is the vowels, and the third, fourth, and fifth groups are the retroflex, dental, and labial consonants; "the sibilants" renders the Sanskrit grammatical term ūṣman, which the Tibetan keeps untranslated, and "the semivowels" renders □□□□□□□□□ (antaḥstha); "emptiness" is the bindu, the nasal dot; and the goddesses' names stand for vowels.

• As in the preceding piece, the commentary decodes the root tantra's mantras letter by letter: "the first" through "the fifth" are the vowel group and the four consonant groups that follow it, "the semivowels" and "the sibilants" render the Sanskrit grammatical terms antaḥstha and ūṣman, "emptiness" is the bindu, "fire" is ra, and the goddesses' names stand for vowels. Readings adopted: □□□□□ as □□□□□, the Tibetan name of the vowel sign i, and □□□□□ as □□□□□, "marks." □□□□□□□ at the head of the mantra for throwing a country into turmoil is taken as the goddess Nairātmyā, but the commentary does not say what it stands for there. In the summary of the tenth chapter, the clause about "the śva of the last" and "sa pa" is obscure as transmitted and is rendered literally.

Colophon

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Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.